Participating in Integration Activities & Participating in Quebec Society: A Study of Integration Programs' Use and Impacts

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Abstract: This study examines how participation in Quebec's integration activities (Programme d'accompagnement et de soutien à l'intégration (PASI)) shapes recent immigrants' integration and civic engagement through policy feedback effects in Quebec. While existing research has explored policy feedback mechanisms among general populations, little attention has been paid to how integration programs may specifically generate resource and interpretive effects for newcomers. Drawing on a panel survey of recent immigrants in Quebec, we first investigate the factors influencing program uptake, testing whether those most likely to experience challenges in their integration process will be those to use PASI integration activities. We then employ matching techniques to assess the causal impact of program participation on various integration outcomes, in terms of political, social and economic integration. Our findings suggest that PASI activities are effectively being used by those most in need of supportive public programs (including non-francophones, racial minorities, and those living outside of the metropolitan region of Montreal). Additionally, we show that these integration activities have several positive and significant impacts on social and political integration, although no impact on economic and linguistic integration in the medium term. This study contributes to both policy feedback theory and immigrant integration research by demonstrating how targeted government programs can serve as catalysts for social and political incorporation among immigrants who are in the early phase of resettlement in a new country.

Paper presented at the 2025 CPSA conference

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In recent years, the integration of immigrants into Western societies has emerged as a politically salient concern (Shehaj, Shin, and Inglehart 2021) with this phenomenon being especially evident in Canada, and more specifically, in the province of Quebec (Bélanger et al. 2022). Concurrently, as Quebec's society becomes increasingly diverse, immigrants face numerous challenges related to integration. These challenges include difficulties in acquiring proficiency in French, which is essential for effective communication, access to quality employment opportunities (Adamuti-Trache et al. 2018) and, more recently, access to government services after 6 months of arriving in Quebec. Additionally, immigrants often face obstacles in securing full-time employment due to factors such as the non-recognition of foreign credentials and job market biases, leading to unemployment or underemployment (Picot 2012; Boudarbat & Adom 2023). Moreover, limited personal resources and social networks can further hinder their integration into Quebec society (Stewart et al. 2008).

To address these challenges, governments have developed a variety of public programs and services specifically tailored to *recent* immigrants, those who have recently arrived in the country. These governmental services aim to assist immigrants in their resettlement process and to facilitate their integration in their host country. In Quebec, as in other countries and regions of the world, the Ministry of immigration has developed, in collaboration with community groups, a whole program of integration activities. This policy initiative - the *Programme d'accompagnement et de soutien à l'intégration* (PASI) - funds and supports the organization of a variety of collective group activities, by community groups, to help recent immigrants acquire new information about their host community, have opportunities to connect with the local culture and way of life, practice the language and create new relationships. PASI aims to help immigrants integrate linguistically, economically, socially and politically, and settle durably in Quebec's community. The objective is to offer them means to "fully participate" in Quebec's society (MIFI 2024).

Policy-makers believe that these integration activities can alleviate some of the challenges to integration and positively impact immigrants' engagement in diverse dimensions of life in the host community. However, only a small number of studies have explored the effectiveness of these integration programs (also referred to as "settlement programs") in achieving their intended goals, and no research has been conducted in Quebec specifically. Furthermore, Quebec's emphasis on a distinct model of integration, known as "interculturalism," along with its focus on the French language and Quebecois culture as foundational elements of its collective identity, introduces unique specificities to its integration process that may differ from other Canadian provinces and international contexts. Additionally, Quebec's collaboration with community organizations in designing and implementing programs like PASI offers an interesting model of public-community partnership that warrants specific examination. These gaps in the literature raise critical questions. First, do recent immigrants actually use these integration programs, and who uses them? While governments develop policies and programs to assist various population groups, these initiatives are not always widely *known* or *accessible* to the targeted clienteles, which results in underutilization or limited reach among those who might benefit the most (Orbach 2006; Radke and Mu 2000). Secondly, do these programs effectively foster integration? Even if public programs have clear objectives, issues in program design and implementation can arise, limiting or nullifying the program's impact, or contextual factors can constrain the impact of programs (Hwang 2024).

Finally, the time required for a program to produce measurable outcomes of integration is an empirical question that warrants further investigation (Godin 2008).

To address these questions, this study capitalizes on a new and innovative panel survey which specifically reached *recent* immigrants in Quebec. Specifically, we aim to, first, identify the factors influencing immigrants' *use* of integration activities, and second, estimate the *impact* of program use on several integration outcomes. Based on the results of the first analyses (i.e. who uses integration activities), in the second step, we proceed to use an analytical strategy based on matching to address the issue of selection bias in integration activities (by controlling for factors impacting both use of programs and integration outcomes) and to estimate more precisely the causal impact of these activities on integration.

Immigrants' integration: processes, dimensions and challenges

Integration is the process through which immigrants become active and valued participants in their host society following their permanent settlement. It encompasses various dimensions, including economic, social, cultural, political, and linguistic aspects (Ager & Strang 2008). Rather than being a unidirectional process of assimilation, integration usually entails an interactive development involving both newcomers and the host society. This process unfolds over time and is characterized by stages that reflect immigrants' changing needs and levels of engagement over time, from the initial phase of settlement, to adaptation, and then eventually achieving full(er) participation in the host society.

At the core of successful integration is the ability of immigrants to navigate and access resources, opportunities, and services that facilitate their inclusion and participation (Berry 1997). Simultaneously a "stated policy goal" and a "targeted outcome" (Ager and Strang 2008), integration usually necessitates proficiency in the host country's language, understanding cultural norms, securing employment, and building social networks. Integration also requires a receptive host society that provides support mechanisms and fosters an environment where diversity is valued (Abood et al. 2021). While it is still debated what 'integration success' means or looks like, there is a general consensus that – at least at the individual level – integration entails immigrants' ability to participate in their host society through "core domains" outlined by Ager and Strang (2008), including the ability to participate in their host society economically, linguistically, socially, culturally and politically (Ager and Strang 2008). These stated objectives are met with very different varieties of settlement services across host countries (Abood et al. 2021).

Borrowing from concepts like those applied to South Korea's Korea Immigration & Integration Program (KIIP) (Hwang 2024), integration can be understood through four interrelated domains: structural, interactive, identificative, and contextual.

Structural integration refers to newcomers' successful inclusion in political, economic, and cultural institutions. This dimension encompasses obtaining secure employment, gaining citizenship or voting rights, achieving language proficiency, and acquiring cultural knowledge (Dewind & Kasinitz 1997). Interactive integration is related to the social networks and relationships that immigrants develop in the host society. Positive interactions with native-born residents, community groups, and other newcomers can facilitate exchange, reduce isolation, and ultimately improve access to information, resources, and support (Heckmann et al. 2010; Portes & Rumbaut 2006). Identificative integration focuses on immigrants' subjective sense of belonging, their satisfaction with life in the new setting, and their comfort in reconciling their origin culture

with that of the host community (Amit 2010; Heckmann et al. 2010). Finally, contextual integration (i.e., the context of acceptance) recognizes that both newcomers and host societies shape integration outcomes (Hwang 2024). These dimensions of integration are a compelling lens through which scholars of immigration can assess the impact of policies like PASI and similar programs elsewhere.

But not everybody moves through integration with the same ease. In fact, some groups have an easier time immigrating and resettling in a country, while others face more challenges and obstacles, and need more time and support to integrate. In fact, the literature on immigration and integration identifies several socio-demographic groups as experiencing more obstacles and difficulties in their integration process (Bloemraad et al. 2023; Harder et al. 2018; Kuschel et al. 2023; Laurentsyeva and Venturini 2017; Waters and Pineau 2016; Zamora-Kapoor et al. 2016). First, immigrants often have an uncertain or temporary legal status, and thus face certain obstacles in finding a job, accessing public services (such as health or education), which are important steps in the integration process. Securing a legal status, and ultimately obtaining citizenship, is associated with better integration outcomes. Also, immigrants from racial, ethnic, religious or cultural backgrounds that differ significantly from the majority population of the host country can face more difficulties in their integration process, as they may be more prone to experience discrimination or prejudice, which can negatively impact their prospects to find a job, make friends and develop a sense of belonging in their new community. Having a limited knowledge and competency in the host country's language is also known to be a significant barrier to integration, be it in employment, education or social connections. The literature on psychological development and socialisation additionally point to the factor of age as potentially representing another challenge in integration. In fact, older people tend to adapt less easily to new contexts or situations (compared to younger people), and thus older immigrants tend to struggle more as they integrate in a new country, especially in terms of language learning and cultural adaptation. Women may as well face specific gender-related challenges. For example, immigrant women are more likely to have several children and may be expected to take over family roles, or some immigrant women may be restricted by cultural or religious norms in their participation in public spaces or employment, which can ultimately slow down or complicate their integration process. While in Quebec a substantial share of immigrants are highly educated, the immigrants who have lower levels of formal education will be faced with lower job prospects, will have a harder time learning the host country’s language and will have a harder time navigating the public administration to access services, which ultimately hinders their integration process.

While all these socio-demographic factors individually affect integration trajectories and outcomes, they may also interact in complex ways, further complicating the integration processes of certain groups of immigrants. These individual challenges will also vary depending on the specific context of the host country, defined notably by its policies, societal attitudes, and economic conditions.

Integration programs: Program Use and Program Impact

As we just noted, the integration process of immigrants is influenced by a multitude of factors, including individual characteristics such as age, education, language proficiency, and pre-migration experiences (Portes & Rumbaut 2001). Institutional policies and the responsiveness of service providers also play critical roles in facilitating or hindering integration processes (Hwang 2024; Lim 2021).

To address the barriers that immigrants face, integration programs (also referred to as "settlement activities") have been developed to provide resources and support mechanisms that facilitate settlement and participation in host countries. These programs often encompass language training, employment assistance, cultural orientation, and community engagement activities (Cheung & Phillimore 2014), aiming to equip immigrants with the necessary skills, knowledge, and social network structures to navigate their new environment effectively.

From a social capital standpoint, group-based integration activities are expected to foster civic engagement by facilitating meaningful interactions and building trust among newcomers and host communities. Such activities help immigrants form supportive social networks, gain access to critical information about institutions and public services, and increase their understanding of political issues and governance structures (Putnam 2000; Fong & Shen 2016; Manatschal, Wisthaler, & Zuber 2020). These interactions can strengthen immigrants' sense of belonging and civic efficacy, ultimately enhancing their willingness to engage in the political process. Conversely, the absence of such activities and resources can impede integration. For instance, Gilmartin and Dagg (2022) demonstrated that in Ireland, gaps in the provision of appropriate settlement services hindered key integration outcomes like quality of work, language proficiency, and housing.

Empirical evidence on the effectiveness of integration programs are mixed, and vary greatly depending on the timeframe studied. Some studies identify positive impacts of well-designed programs, while others report limited, null, or even negative outcomes. For example, combined language and work experience programs have been shown to significantly enhance immigrants' language proficiency and employment readiness. In the Netherlands, low-literacy refugees who participated in programs combining language training with work experience developed a stronger sense of agency in speaking the host language, preparing them for employment (Kuschel et al. 2023). Similarly, in South Korea, the Korea Immigration & Integration Program (KIIP) has been instrumental in improving immigrants' cultural adaptation, sense of belonging, and satisfaction with economic conditions (Lim 2021; Hwang 2024). Lim (2021) found that KIIP participants exhibited higher levels of social integration compared to non-participants, particularly in terms of cultural adaptation and social belonging.

Despite these positive findings, there are instances where integration programs have fallen short of their stated objectives. For instance, Hwang (2024) noted that while KIIP played a role in raising levels of naturalization and acceptance of Korean culture among immigrants, there were no statistically significant differences in employment, income, or the structure of social networks between participants and non-participants. Similarly, in Sweden, Syrian refugees participating in settlement programs expressed that the programs were not adapted to their qualifications and experiences (Bucken-Knapp, Fakih, & Spehar 2019). Highly educated refugees were particularly critical of the organization of language courses, which highlighted a need for more advanced and specialized language training that aligns with their educational credentials.

Further complicating the picture regarding integration outcomes, some studies have found that integration policies might not narrow, and could even widen, specific gaps between immigrants and the native-born population. De Coninck and Solano (2023) showed that in some rural, culturally homogeneous regions of Europe, integration policies did little to narrow the employment gap. In contrast, in highly competitive, diverse urban areas, integration policies were associated with a wider employment gap. Finally, Kogan (2016) found that labour market training and counselling programs for immigrants in Europe often failed to improve employment outcomes, potentially due to ineffective training designs and unfavourable participant selection effects.

Nevertheless, past research has identified components of integration programs that yield positive results across multiple dimensions of integration. Language acquisition and cultural knowledge are especially important, as language proficiency allows newcomers to access employment, education, and public services more effectively, and facilitates their overall integration (Esser 2006; Cheung & Phillimore 2014). Programs integrating language training with work experience can help participants gain greater autonomy over time (Kuschel et al. 2023). In Germany, Battisti et al. (2019) observed delayed but positive effects of job search assistance on certain subgroups of refugees after twelve months.

Beyond economic and linguistic dimensions, integration programs can also influence social and civic outcomes by generating trust in institutions and promoting civic participation. Abood et al. (2021) introduced the concept of "Immigrant Settlement Services Literacy" (ISSL) to capture immigrants' ability to know, access, and navigate settlement services. Their findings suggest that enhancing ISSL through well-designed programs can reduce linguistic and systemic barriers, ultimately improving integration outcomes. The effectiveness of integration programs, therefore, depends on various factors including their design, implementation, and alignment with the specific needs of immigrant populations.

While public integration programs are becoming increasingly important, in a context of increasing migration fluxes and public scrutiny on immigrants' integration, very few studies have actually examined whether the objectives of these programs are met and whether recent immigrants' integration is indeed facilitated by integration activities and services. In Canada, as elsewhere in the world, research is scarce on integration programs' access and usage among recent immigrants, and there is limited causal evidence regarding the impact of these programs on integration outcomes. Additionally, much of the existing literature is based on observational studies or qualitative assessments, which - while informative about the value of the programs - cannot speak about the causal effects of the programs (Battisti et al. 2019).

One significant challenge in evaluating integration programs is accounting for selection bias. Indeed, immigrants who choose to use integration programs and services may be different in a number of ways from those who do not use these services. This complicates efforts to evaluate the true impact of these programs (Lim 2021). Statistical approaches that adjust for potential confounders are therefore necessary. For example, Hwang (2024) used inverse-probability weighted analysis to evaluate the Korea Immigration & Integration Program (KIIP) in South Korea, finding that the program played a role in raising levels of naturalization and acceptance of Korean culture, but that it did not significantly impact employment levels or the structure of social networks.

Furthermore, most studies assess the impact of integration activities on a single integration outcome, such as economic or linguistic outcomes, leaving gaps in understanding how integration programs impact immigrants' integration more holistically (Entzinger & Biezeveld 2003). In fact,

it is possible that activities focused on language acquisition can do more than just develop immigrants' language competencies, and for instance, promote understanding of the host culture and cultural adaptation (Lim 2021). As such, there is a need for *multidimensional* assessments that consider the potentially multiple and diverse social, cultural, and political outcomes of integration programs.

Furthermore, the literature on integration programs' impacts is limited in temporal scope. In fact, very few studies have looked into long-term dynamics when it comes to integration programs and immigration outcomes. First, we note than only a few scholars have looked into immigrants' integration over a long time, like Godin (2018) with a 10 year study, or Lichtenstein and Puma (2004) who developed a four year longitudinal study, or Piché et al. (2002) in Quebec who mobilized a longitudinal design to examine economic integration over the span of 18 years. And when we consider studies that have investigated specifically the role of integration programs in integration processes, they primarily focus on short-term outcomes, typically measured through cross-sectional designs that capture immediate changes, such as improvements in language proficiency, early social ties, or initial employment (e.g., Portes 1995) within a few months of settlement (e.g., De La Rosa et al. 2013). But short-term program evaluations may underestimate the benefits (or costs) of integration programs that only become apparent years after participants have settled into their host societies, and such evaluations can overlook unanticipated spillover effects, such as those related to nation-building and broader societal cohesion (Collins 2013). All in all, although there are a few exceptions that are especially focused on the medium term (e.g., Sarvimaki and Hamalainen 2010), the emphasis remains on short-term changes in attitudes or outcomes.

The case of Quebec: Integration model and integration services

Since the 1970s, Quebec's integration model, known as "interculturalism", has served as the foundation for policies addressing the province's growing ethnic and cultural diversity (Bouchard 2011). This model emerges from the unique status of French-speaking Québécois within Canada: with a minority status within the canadian federation, but a majority status within Quebec's province. Interculturalism aims to foster dialogue and interactions to achieve mutual understanding and respect between cultural groups, and to build commonalities and shared values, through the use of French as the common public language (Gagnon & Iacovino 2007).

The integration model of interculturalism guides the development and implementation of Quebec's governmental policies, and notably the policies and programs of the Ministère de l'Immigration, de la Francisation et de l'Intégration (MIFI). In 2020, a new *Programme d'accompagnement et de soutien à l'intégration* (PASI, in English: the Integration accompaniment and support program) was implemented to support community organizations assisting immigrants in their settlement process in order to promote immigrants' participation in Quebec's French-speaking society (MIFI 2024). The PASI offers a great variety of group activities, such as workshops on the job market, cultural dinners, visits at the sugar shack, French discussion groups, information sessions on Canada and Quebec's institutions, and more. Through participation in these activities, the program aims to promote recent immigrants' active involvement in civic, community, cultural, economic, identity, and linguistic domains of life in Quebec, and ultimately to foster the "full participation" of newcomers in Quebec's collective life (MIFI 2024).

Theoretical framework and Hypotheses

Explaining use of integration programs

Two different literatures lead to contradictory expectations about which groups of immigrants would be more likely to use integration services. On one hand, the resource model and rational choice theory lead us to think that immigrants who face more integration challenges and who are less resourceful will be more likely to use integration services. As we identified earlier, certain groups of immigrants (such as the less educated and non-francophones) will face more hurdles in their adaptation and settlement process due to a lack of resources (for example, less ability to navigate institutional systems or inability to speak the language of the host country), and they are the most in need of support services and integration assistance. With lower initial resources for integration, they should see *higher benefits* in the PASI integration services, and if the time and administrative *costs* of accessing and participating in the program aren't too high, they are more likely to use the integration services, compared to immigrants who initially have more resources for integration..

On the other hand, the literature on the administrative burden (Daigeault 2023; Safarov 2023) and 'Immigrant Settlement Services Literacy' (ISSL) lead us to the opposite expectation. Notably, Abood et al. (2021) show that newcomers lacking ISSL (i.e. the capacity to know, access, and critically navigate settlement services) are disproportionately disadvantaged by system complexity, inadequate language support, and unfamiliar administrative tasks. Weaker language abilities, in particular, emerge as a near-universal barrier, constraining both knowledge of services and the ability to use them effectively. So ultimately, those with the fewest resources (in terms of literacy, language, education, or cultural capital) are often the least equipped to overcome integration hurdles and to overcome the hurdles of access to public services. This would lead the resourceless immigrants to be less likely to use integration programs, compared to the more apt and resourceful immigrants.

While these two literature strands lead us to envision contradictory expectations about integration program use, the specific policy design of the PASI integration program leads us to develop a clearer expectation. The PASI program is *not* a public program administered by the Quebec government, that service clienteles would need to access through the main governmental portal or general administrative offices. The PASI program has been designed to be offered *only* by community groups that have the specific mission of assisting refugees and immigrants[1]. These organisations are located in neighborhoods with high concentrations of landing immigrants, but also in cities across the province. These organisations are the most knowledgeable about their clientele and are uniquely positioned to advertise and offer PASI activities with the lowest barriers to access (for example, they hire former service users and social workers with immigrant backgrounds who speak several languages). In other terms, they highlight the benefits and tailor them to their clientele, and at the same time lower the costs of access and participation in their activities. This policy design minimizes the knowledge needed to access services and the obstacles to access the services, and thus, in line with the resource and rational choice perspective, we believe that:

[1] All te community groups are members of a province wide association called: *The Cooperation Group of Organizations Serving Refugees and Immigrants*

Hypothesis 1: the *less resourceful* immigrants will be more likely to use and take part in PASI activities (i.e. immigrants who are older, female, non-francophone, racialized, with children, and living outside Montreal).

Explaining integration programs' impact

Policy feedback theory can be mobilized to better understand how public programs impact individuals' attitudes, behaviours, and identities (Pierson 1993; Mettler & Soss 2004). The theory of policy feedback effects posits that the impact of governmental programs materializes through two mechanisms: the resource effects and the interpretive effects (Béland et al., 2022; Mettler, 2002; Pierson, 1993). On one hand, social programs may compensate for lack of resources (such as financial or educational resources), and by providing material resources, programs may build civic capacities, shape political orientations, and alleviate barriers to participation (Campbell, 2002; Campbell, 2003). On the other hand, on a more symbolic level, social policies and program may demonstrate the importance of the role of government and public institutions, and convey messages about the legitimacy of groups' needs, which may shape individuals' attitudes towards institutions and provide incentives for individuals to take action to demand more services and/or protect the existing services (Pierson, 1993; Schneider & Ingram, 1993, 1997). Policies may also present signals of social inclusion (or exclusion) and affect people's sense of belonging and attachment to the host community (Filindra et al., 2011; Filindra & Manatschal, 2020).

While many studies have shown the existence of these policy feedback effects among various populations and in various countries (Bruch et al., 2010; Jacobs et al., 2022; Lerman & McCabe, 2017; Mettler, 2002, 2005; Soss, 1999; Soss & Jacobs, 2009), there has been only one study conducted on feedback effects in Canada (Gidengil 2020), and only two studies have looked into these effects with newcomers (Breidahl & Fersch, 2018; and Filindra & Manatschal, 2020). But the expectation is that use of public programs should be particularly important for immigrants for two reasons. First, as newcomers are in the process of resettlement, they are much more likely to contact public offices and use public programs to sort out installation issues and paperwork. Secondly, based on the literature on resocialization, we know that, as newcomers are discovering and learning to adapt to their new social and political context, their *early experiences* with public services and governmental programs are likely to be particularly consequential and impactful for their resocialization and to leave a lasting imprint on their political attitudes (Anderson & Black, 2008).

Applying policy feedback theory to immigrants' integration suggests that integration programs can generate feedback effects that could enhance immigrants' engagement with and integration in their host society. In the context of integration programs, this means that participation in such services may be able to provide *resources* to address immediate settlement needs, and also offer *symbolic* signals that institutions, groups and society as a whole consider immigrants' needs and provide support for them to be included in the community. We believe that in the case of the PASI integration programs, the resource mechanism should be stronger than the interpretive mechanism.

In fact, PASI integration activities have been developed to offer a variety of *non-material resources* to their clientele, would it be: knowledge about public services, political institutions, Quebec's culture and societal norms; social capital developed through networking activities, shared meals in the local community, visits at other community groups and opportunities for volunteering; or, competencies to apply on a job, speak French or open a bank account. While

some PASI activities are tailored towards one specific domain of integration, they generally develop a diverse set of resources and are linked to different aspects of integration. For example, some activities aim at learning the Quebec culture, but for that, they also often involve being in contact with different groups in the community and also speaking French, thus developing cultural knowledge, French competency and social connections, all at the same time. Thus, we expect that:

> *Hypothesis 2:* participation in PASI integration activities will have a positive impact on immigrants' social, political, economic and linguistic integration outcomes.

However, as we noted earlier, certain dimensions of integration involve a dependance on structural context or societal actors, which is the case for linguistic integration (where interlocutors are needed to be involved in a linguistic exchange) and economic integration (where opportunities for employment must exist and employers must be willing to recognize the abilities of the candidate and to hire them). Thus, we expect that:

> *Hypothesis 2a:* PASI integration activities will be more likely to have positive effects on integration outcomes that are more under the individual's control (such as social and political integration, with social engagement with the host society, political engagement, satisfaction with resettlement), rather than for outcomes subject to contextual constraints (such economic and linguistic integration).

Methods

Data and Sample

This study capitalizes on a new original two-wave panel survey conducted with recent immigrants in Quebec (Mahéo 2024). The survey was designed to examine immigrants and non-immigrants' participation in various domains of life in Quebec, over time, and to assess respondents' use public programs and services, of which the *Programme d'accompagnement et de soutien à l'intégration* (PASI).

The first wave of the survey was administered in May and June 2023. Respondents were recruited directly by the Ministère de l'Immigration, de la Francisation et de l'Intégration (MIFI) of Quebec and with the support of community groups. The Ministry selected from the official immigration registry a sample of 10,000 adult immigrants who had arrived in Quebec in the past 5 years, and sent them an email invitation[2] to take part in an academic survey on residents' opinions and experiences with public services. The survey was administered online, in French and English. Of the initial sample, 2,586 immigrants completed the survey in part, producing a response rate of 26%. But for the current study, we only use fully completed surveys[3], which amount to 1,831 immigrant respondents in Wave 1. The second wave was administered one year later, in May and July 2024, to the same respondents who had completed in full the first survey (Wave 1), who had agreed to be recontacted and who had provided a valid email address, which represents 1,331

[2] Immigrants were informed that this survey had nothing to do with their immigration process, that the survey was conducted by an academic team, independently of the Ministry, and that their responses would remain confidential. Participation was voluntary, and incentives were offered to encourage response rates.

[3] We consider as 'fully completed' surveys, the surveys that have 80% of questions answered.

individuals from Wave 1 (so 73% of the Wave 1 full completes). In Wave 2, 988 immigrants completed the survey in full, resulting in a retention rate of 74% from Wave 1 to Wave 2.

Analytical Strategy and Variables of Interest

Our first objective is to examine the factors influencing recent immigrants' participation in the *Programme d'accompagnement et de soutien à l'intégration* (PASI) activities. Thus in the first part of the analyses, we use only Wave 1 and run logistic regressions[4] to model the probability of participation in PASI, based on demographic, socioeconomic, and contextual factors.

In the first part of the analysis, our dependent variable is *PASI activity use* in Wave 1, coded as a binary variable where a value of 1 indicates that the respondent has participated in *at least one* the 25 PASI activities in Wave 1, and 0 indicates no participation. But, in addition to the "overall PASI participation", we are also interested in understanding participation in *specific types* of integration activities. Thus, we regrouped the 25 distinct PASI activities in four main types of integration activities[5]: linguistic activities (aimed at enhancing proficiency in the French language and providing opportunities to practice French); community and cultural activities (designed to foster cultural understanding and social connections within Quebec society); economic activities (focused on employment support and job market integration); and civic and administrative activities (aimed at increasing knowledge about political and public institutions and facilitating access to public services). We estimate separate logistic regression models for each activity type - linguistic, economic, cultural or civic-, and assess whether different factors influence participation in these domain specific integration activities.

Our models incorporate a range of independent variables[6] hypothesized to influence participation in integration activities. Age is included as a continuous variable, as it may influence participation due to varying levels of adaptability, responsibilities, and integration needs at different life stages. Gender is a binary indicator where women are coded as 1 and men as 0. Gender differences may affect use of integration activities because of societal roles, responsibilities, and potential integration barriers faced by women. Educational attainment is represented by a binary variable indicating whether the respondent holds a university degree (1) or not (0). Higher education levels may affect awareness of and access to integration programs. Francophone status is included as a binary variable where non-Francophones are coded as 1, indicating that French is not the respondent's primary language, and Francophones are coded as 0. We also consider whether the respondent has children, coded as a binary variable, as having children might influence participation due to increased integration needs or time constraints. Region of residence is represented by a binary variable where residing in the metropolitan region of Montreal is coded as 1 and residing in other non-metropolitan regions as 0. Regional differences could impact access to programs (for example due to distance to service points) and the availability of services. Racial minority status is a binary variable indicating whether the respondent identifies as part of a racial minority group (1) or not (0). Lastly, we include the number of years of residence in Quebec as a categorical variable with intervals (0–1 year, 2–3 years, 4–5 years, 6-7 years, and

[4] This method is appropriate for dichotomous outcomes and allows us to estimate the relationship between the independent variables and the log-odds of the outcome occurring.

[5] The details on all PASI activities and the regrouping under the four categories are provided in Table A1 of the Appendix.

[6] The coding scheme of all variables, as well as descriptive statistics, are presented in the Table A1 of the Appendix.

8 years or more). The length of stay may influence familiarity with available services and integration stages.

For all the logistic regression models explaining *overall participation* in PASI activities and use of *each specific type* of PASI activities, for ease of interpretation, we calculate and present the Average Marginal Effects (AMEs) for each independent variable[7]. All analyses are based on Wave 1 respondents (N=1831), except for the model explaining use of linguistic activities, which is restricted to non-Francophone respondents only (N=1183), as individuals whose primary language is French would not use language enhancement programs .

Our second objective is to estimate the causal impact of PASI activities on integration. Thus, in the second part of the analyses, we capitalize on the panel design of the survey to estimate the impact of use of PASI programs in Wave 1 on various dimensions of integration in Wave 2.

Here, we aim to mitigate the main obstacle in the estimation of the causal effect of integration program use on integration outcomes: the fact that *program use* is not random. Indeed, the characteristics that impact *program use* are not exogenous and not independent from the downstream integration outcomes that we are interested in. Thus, in the second part of the analyses, we build upon the existing literature that uses propensity score matching on observable characteristics to reduce the problem of endogeneity. Propensity score matching has been used to determine the causal impact of processes which are impossible to randomize, such as incarceration or education (Gerber et al. 2017; Henderson and Chatfield 2011). The main objective of matching is to create comparable groups by *pairing or matching* individuals who are similar in terms of their observed characteristics, but who are different in terms of a treatment, which, in our case, is integration program use. This matching of similar individuals - some who have been treated and some who have not been treated - mimics the randomization process in experimental designs and thus improves the validity of the causal inference.

Among a variety of matching techniques, *full matching*[8] provided the most optimal covariate balance between the matched and unmatched samples. The matching procedure was implemented using Wave 1 covariates to ensure *causal and temporal precedence* relative to our Wave 2 integration outcomes. The balance assessment, through standardized mean differences, shows substantial improvement in covariate balance, compared to the non-matched sample, with most matched covariates achieving values near or below conventional thresholds (Stuart 2010)[9]. In all the analyses of the second part, we still include the matched covariates in the model specification to help remove any residual confounding, in accordance with the best practices for "doubly robust" Average-Treatment-on-the-Treated estimates (ATT) (Stuart 2010; Ho et al. 2007; Nguyen et al. 2017).

We matched the treated and untreated (i.e. PASI users and non-users) on the following covariates: the respondent arrived through the economic immigration program, the respondent's education level, gender, age, region of residence, racial minority status, presence of children,

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[7] All the regression models are presented in Tables A2 of the Appendix.

[8] Full matching creates a series of matched sets, where each set contains either one treated unit and multiple controls, or one control unit and multiple treated units, optimizing the overall balance of covariates while retaining all observations (Hansen 2004).

[9] This approach maximizes statistical efficiency compared to fixed-ratio matching methods, while minimizing bias that could arise from discarding unmatched units. In the Appendix, we show the comparison between the covariate balances between matched and unmatched samples in Figures A1 through A3.

citizenship status, whether they participated in an economic program, primary language (French or not), and number of years of residence in Quebec. For all these variables, the coding is the same as in Part 1 of the analyses. These variables were selected based on their theoretical importance in predicting both selection into the program and potential outcomes. As in the first part of the analysis, for outcomes related to French competency and use, we exclude native French speakers from the analysis, and consequently do not include francophone status as a matching covariate. Additionally, for economic outcomes, we further matched on full time employment status.

In assessing the impact of PASI integration activities on a variety of integration outcomes, we consider the following outcomes[10]: *political engagement* (measured with the level of interest in Quebec politics), *political knowledge* (measured with the number of correct answers to four questions about politics in Quebec and Canada), *belonging in Quebec* (measured with self reported feeling of belonging), *use of French in public spaces* (such as stores or on the street) and *level of competency in French* (both self-reported measures), *volunteering* (the number of times that respondents reported participating in volunteer activities in the past year), *income* (in the form of self reported hourly pay rate), *current financial satisfaction with life* (also self reported), *intention to stay in Quebec* (based on if respondents reported as being likely to move in the near future), and finally *experiences in Quebec* (self-reported score). We operationalize these outcomes in two different ways: W2 values of the integration outcome, and the change in the integration outcome between waves (W1 Values subtracted from W2 values). This approach allows us to distinguish between lasting program effects (manifested in W2 values) and temporal decay or enhancement of initial impacts (captured by wave-to-wave changes). For ease of interpretation, all outcomes were scaled from 0 to 1 in the models presented. Together, these specifications provide complementary evidence about whether the effects of PASI participation persist beyond the immediate post-treatment period.

Results

Part 1: Who Uses Integration Programs?

Just over 40% of Wave 1 survey respondents indicated they had participated in at least one PASI group activity[11]. Among these participants, the most popular option—an employment/job market or professional networking workshop—was attended by 34.2% of all *users*. To classify the types of activities, we employ an original categorization based on their targeted outcomes. The range of PASI group activities features one linguistic activity, 12 community and cultural activities, nine civic and administrative activities, and two economic activities. Table 1 displays the distribution of activity use according to this classification for Wave 1, and Table A1 provides the full categorization of all activities.

[10] The survey questions and coding for all these outcomes are presented in Table A11 in the Appendix.

[11] Figure A6 in the Appendix shows the number of activities each respondent took part in during Wave 1.

Table 1. Distribution of Activities per Category

Category	Participation by Category in Wave 1	% of W1 Respondents
Civic & Administrative Activities	354	19.67%
Community & Cultural Activities	609	33.85%
Economic Activities	425	17.80%
Linguistic Activities	259	14.40%

To assess H1, we begin our analysis by examining who uses PASI integration activities. We estimate five logistic regression models to assess the predictors of PASI group activity (PGA) use, as well as civic, economic, linguistic and cultural integration activity use. We present the average marginal effects (AMEs) of each predictor for the five distinct PASI activity areas in Figure 1. These AMEs reflect the change in the predicted probability of *PASI activity use* in the indicated set of activities associated with a one-unit increase in a continuous variable (like age), or a shift from the reference category to another category for binary or categorical variables. As potential predictors, the models include traditional socioeconomic characteristics (e.g., education), compositional effects (i.e. individuals with specific predispositions self-selecting into the programs) and contextual effects (e.g., region of residence).

First, for *overall PASI group activity use* (PGA, in black in Figure 1), age is positively and significantly associated with program use. Older immigrants are slightly more likely to make use of activities; on average, a one-year increase in age corresponds to about a 0.47 percentage point increase in the probability of using a PASI activity. A similar positive and statistically significant effect of age emerges for civic and administrative, community and cultural, and economic activities. For linguistic activities, the effect of age is weaker and non-statistically significant. Overall, older immigrants tend to be slightly more involved in a range of integration activities.

Second, women are almost always more likely than men to use integration activities, both overall and across two types of PASI activities (out of four). We see for example a use of community activities for women that is about 8.9 percentage points above the average level of use for men. When they are statistically significant, the average marginal effects of gender are quite important in terms of magnitude.

Third, university education does not show a strong, consistent or statistically significant effect on use of integration activities. Highly educated newcomers do not appear more or less likely to use activities than less educated respondents, once other factors are taken into account.

Fourth, we turn to the effect of language.[12] Individuals whose native language is not French are positively and significantly associated with greater use of all types of integration activities, including overall use of PASI activity groups (in black), civic and administrative activities (in red), community and cultural activities (in blue) and economic activities (in green). For example, non-francophones are approximately 9.5 percentage points more likely to enroll in at least one PASI group activity, regardless of the specific activity area. In contrast, living outside Montreal corresponds to a reduction of 4.6 percentage points in linguistic activity use

Fifth, having children does not appear to strongly or systematically influence the use of integration activities. The estimated effects are not statistically significant, which suggests that differences in family structure may not be a key driver of use of PASI group activities.

[12] As a reminder, the analyses on linguistic activities are excluding all native French speakers.

Next, immigrants residing outside the metropolitan Montreal area are more likely to use PASI activities overall (in black, by about 6.4 percentage points), as well as a variety of integration activities —civic and administrative, community and cultural, and economic activities. In contrast, for linguistic activities (in purple), living outside Montreal has a negative effect.

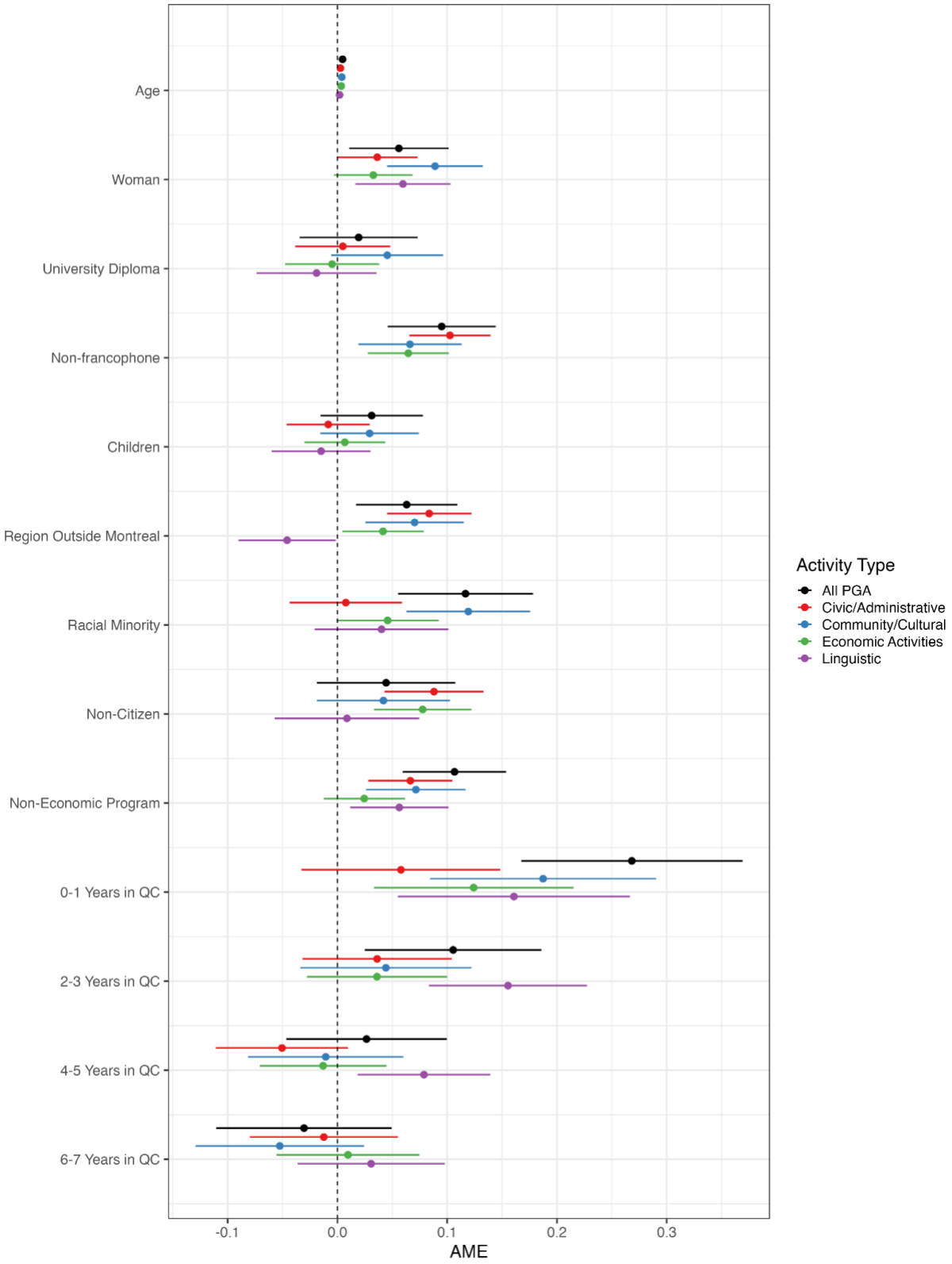
For any PASI activity use, use of economic activities and use of community-cultural activities, identifying as a racial minority is positively associated with greater use of these integration activities. For example, individuals who identify as a racial minority present an overall use of PASI activities about 11.7 percentage points above non racialized minorities. For civic-administrative and linguistic activities, the effect of being a racial minority is positive but not statistically significant.

Next, being a non-citizen is associated with a higher likelihood of using integration activities, but the effect is only statistically significant for civic & administrative activities (in red) and economic activities (in green). For instance, non-citizens are about 7.8 percentage points more likely to make use of economic activities compared to citizens, suggesting that individuals without Canadian citizenship may be more inclined to seek out resources.

Furthermore, those who immigrated to Quebec through a non-economic immigration program are more likely to use PASI integration activities overall, as well as civic & administrative, and community & cultural activities. For example, overall use of PASI (i.e., using any PASI group activities, in black) is about 10.7 percentage points higher among non-economic immigrants, relative to individuals who immigrated to Quebec through an economic program. For economic integration activities, the effect is much weaker and not statistically significant. This suggests that newcomers who arrive through non-economic programs might have greater needs for support initially, whereas "economic immigrants" may feel better prepared upon arrival.

Finally, in the bottom four sections of Figure 1, presented on the y-axis, we find an important effect of time spent in Quebec. In fact, immigrants who have just very recently arrived in Quebec (i.e. who spent 0-1 year in Quebec) are much more likely to use any PASI group activities, compared to immigrants who have lived in Quebec for 8 years or more (the reference group). For 0 to 1 year spent in Quebec, this difference is statistically significant for all types of activities, except for civic-administrative activities (in red). For example, relative to those who have spent 8 years or more in Quebec, newcomers in their first year are about 26.8 percentage points more likely to make use of a PASI group activity. But we note that, as expected, more time in Quebec is associated with a lower probability of activity use. For example, those who have lived in Quebec 2 to 3 years are 3.6 percentage points more likely to use *any* PASI integration activities *(in black)*, relative to those who have spent 8 years or more in Quebec. And the difference in use of *any* PASI group activities between those who have been in Quebec 4-5 or 6-7 years, and those who have been in Quebec 8 years or more, becomes non significant. For some integration activities (i.e. linguistic activities), we note that using these integration activities for a longer period of time, as we note that the individuals who have been in Quebec for 0-1, 2-3, and 4-5 years present significantly higher use.

Figure 1. Determinants of Activity Use (Average Marginal Effects)



Overall, our expectations tend to confirm our first hypothesis (H1). In fact, we find that the immigrants who are more likely to experience challenges in their integration process – older immigrants, women, those who do not have French as their primary language, individuals who did not arrive in Quebec through an economic program, those living outside of the metropolitan area of Montreal, and those who have arrived very recently in Quebec – are more likely to use integration programs. Also in line with our expectations, individuals who are not citizens and who identify as racialized minorities are also more likely to use integration programs, but not across all types of integration programs. In the end, only two sociodemographic characteristics presented no statistically significant association with any integration program: education and parental status.

Part 2: Do Integration Activities Foster Integration?

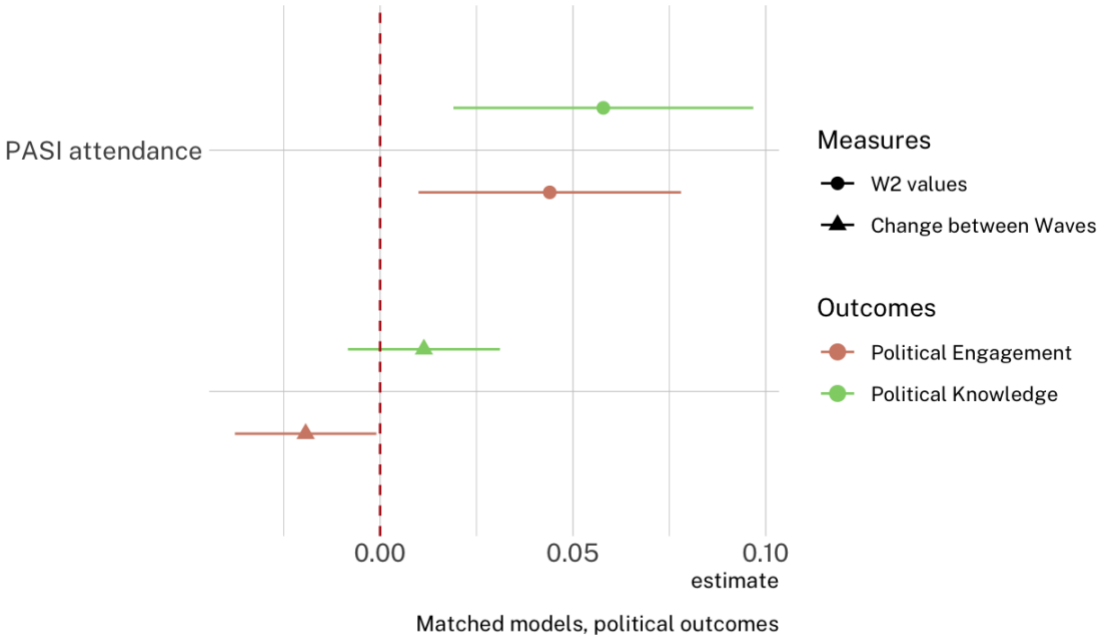
Having examined the patterns of PASI integration activity *use* among recent immigrants in Quebec, we now turn to the central question of whether such *activity use* fosters integration into Quebec society. In this section, we address the causal relationship between engagement in PASI activities in Wave 1 and key dimensions of integration in Wave 2. More specifically, in this section, we examine how PASI activities impact political integration (using political engagement and knowledge measures), social integration (using volunteering and feelings of belonging in Quebec society), linguistic integration (with French language use in public spaces and French language competency), economic integration (looking at hourly income and personal satisfaction with one's financial situation), and the overall immigration experience (with subjective evaluation of experiences in Quebec and the likelihood of one staying in the province).

As previously noted, the characteristics driving PASI participation are likely endogenous to our outcomes of interest. To address this non-random selection into treatment (i.e. use of integration activities), we employ propensity score matching on our Wave 1 observable characteristics. After testing various matching approaches, full matching provided optimal covariate balance while retaining all observations in our sample. The matching procedure used Wave 1 covariates to ensure temporal precedence relative to Wave 2 outcomes, with balance diagnostics showing substantial improvements in covariate distributions (see Figures A1-A3). Following best practices for doubly robust Average Treatment on the Treated estimation (ATT), we retain the matched covariates in our model specifications to address potential residual confounding. This approach builds on established applications of matching methods to observational data in political science, particularly in contexts where randomization is infeasible. Covariates are included in all models based on matched data, but not shown, as they should not be interpreted causally. All the tables presenting all models, both matched and unmatched, can be found in the Appendix (Tables A3 to A9).

Figure 2 shows the association between PASI use and political outcomes. When examining changes in political outcomes between waves (the triangles), we observe in the lower section of Figure 2 more modest relationships. There is a small negative association with change in political engagement ($\beta = -0.019$, $p < 0.05$), and a positive relationship with change in volunteerism ($\beta = 0.028$, $p < 0.01$). We find no statistically significant effect of PASI on overtime change in feeling of belonging and political knowledge. These results suggest that while PASI use corresponds with higher political engagement in Wave 2, the effect may be subject to temporal decay. The strongest and most consistent impact of PASI programs is found for social integration, as PASI use leads

not only to higher levels of volunteering in the second wave, but an *increase in* level of volunteerism in Wave 2 relative to Wave 1.

Figure 2 - Average Treatment Effect of PASI programs on the Treated: Political Integration Outcomes



With regards to political engagement, we find positive associations with both political engagement and knowledge in Wave 2, supporting our initial expectations. While attitudinally, we fail to find a significant relationship between program participation and subjective feelings of belonging in Quebec, in terms of attitudes, we do observe a consistent and robust relationship between *behaviors* that might plausibly signal this, in the form of increased proclivity to volunteerism. The implications of this are potentially significant, as much of the existent literature would have us expect the opposite: that attitudes are easier to shift than concrete behaviors.

We do observe a significant negative association when it comes to change in levels of political engagement between waves. However, the negative association with changes in political engagement between waves requires careful interpretation. Rather than indicating program ineffectiveness, this pattern likely reflects a ceiling effect: as shown in Figure A4 in the appendix, PASI participants begin with notably higher levels of political engagement. So starting with higher baseline engagement, they have less room for growth compared to PASI non-participants, even if they show higher absolute levels in Wave 2. This interpretation is supported by the robust positive relationship between PASI participation and political knowledge in Wave 2, suggesting that the program successfully maintains and reinforces political interest among an already engaged population.

Figure 3 presents results from matched models examining the effect of PASI use on linguistic outcomes. As previously noted, native French speakers were excluded from this analysis.

First, looking at Wave 2 values (triangles), we note that PASI use in Wave 1 has no effect on French competency in Wave 2 ($\beta = 0.002$, n.s.) and has a small negatively but not statistically significant effect on use of French language in public spaces ($\beta = -0.053$, $p < 0.1$). When examining changes between waves, we observe no significant effect of PASI on changes in linguistic measures, with both coefficients small in magnitude and statistically insignificant ($\beta = -0.005$ for both measures). These findings suggest very limited effects of PASI activities on linguistic integration in the time span of a year.

With regards to linguistic outcomes, other than a negative effect of PASI on use of French in public spaces, we mainly do not find much association between PASI attendance and our linguistic measures. It's possible that program participation could make immigrants more aware of their linguistic limitations, leading them to be more conservative in self-reporting their linguistic competency or use of French (compared to those who do not take part in PASI). Overall, we find little association between use of integration programs and linguistic outcomes.

Figure 3 - Average Treatment Effect of PASI programs on the Treated: Linguistic Outcomes

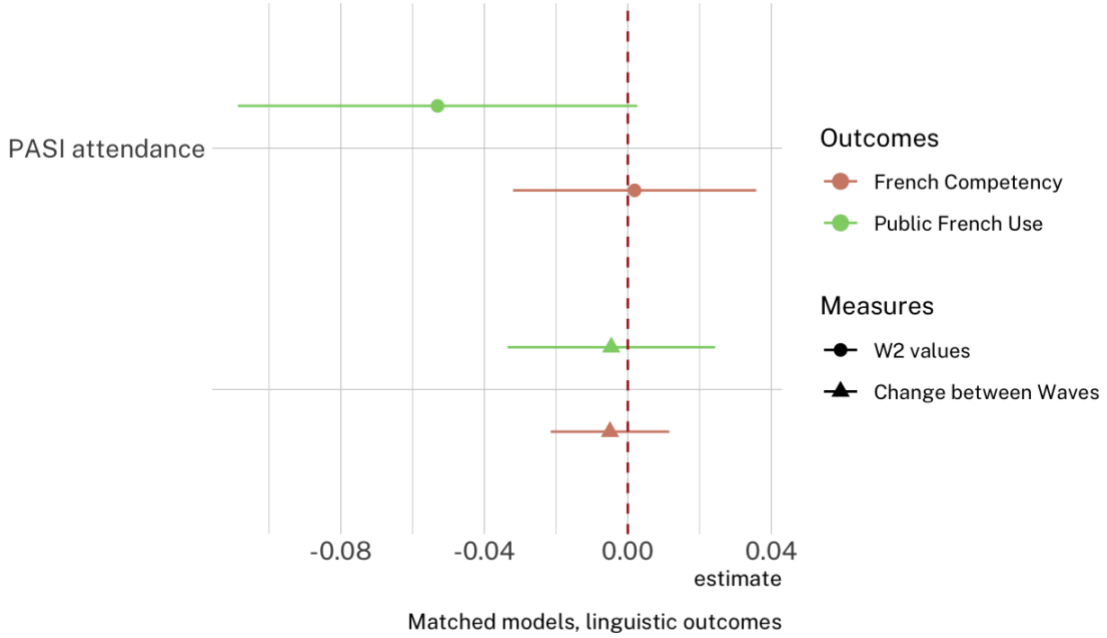
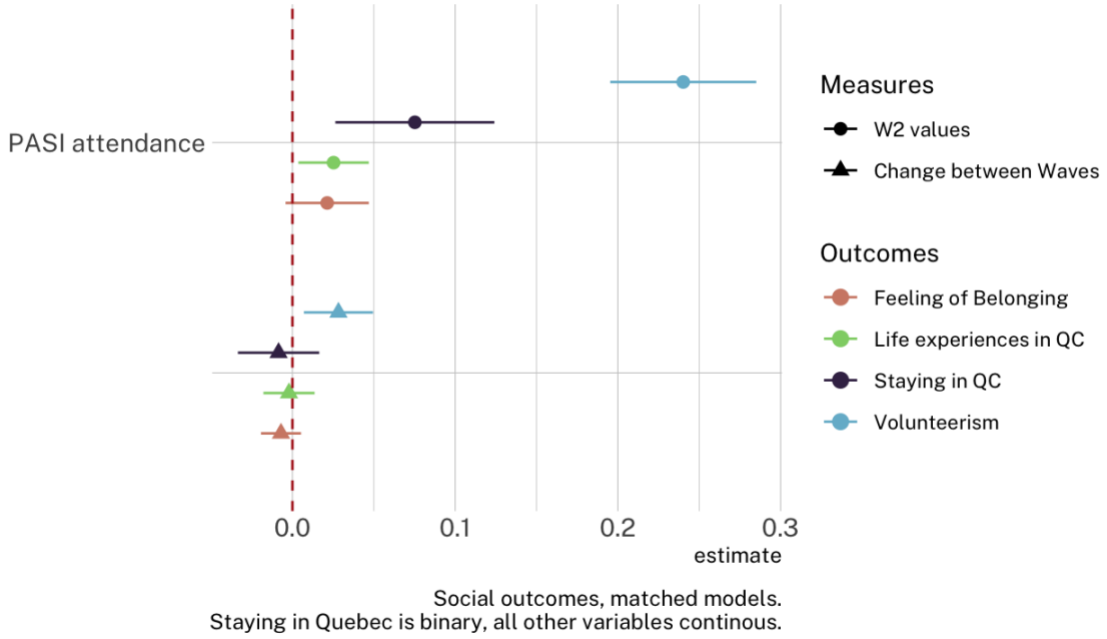


Figure 4 presents comprehensive results from matched models examining PASI's associations with integration outcomes. Looking at Wave 2 values, PASI programs show positive and statistically significant associations with political engagement ($\beta = 0.044$, $p < 0.05$), political knowledge ($\beta = 0.058$, $p < 0.01$), volunteerism ($\beta = 0.240$, $p < 0.001$), life experiences in Quebec ($\beta = 0.025$, $p < 0.05$), and intentions to stay in the province ($\beta = 0.075$, $p < 0.01$). The effect on volunteerism is particularly substantial, while the relationship with feelings of belonging in Quebec ($\beta = 0.21$, $p > 0.10$), though positive, fails to reach standard levels of statistical significance. Notably, participation in PASI activities is associated with a 7.5 percentage point increase in the probability of expressing intentions to remain in Quebec. However, when examining changes between waves, we find no substantial or significant associations between

PASI and changes in resettlement outcomes over time (β = -0.002 and β = -0.009 respectively), a pattern that mirrors our findings for political engagement. This likely reflects ceiling effects where PASI participants begin with higher baseline levels of provincial attachment and political engagement.

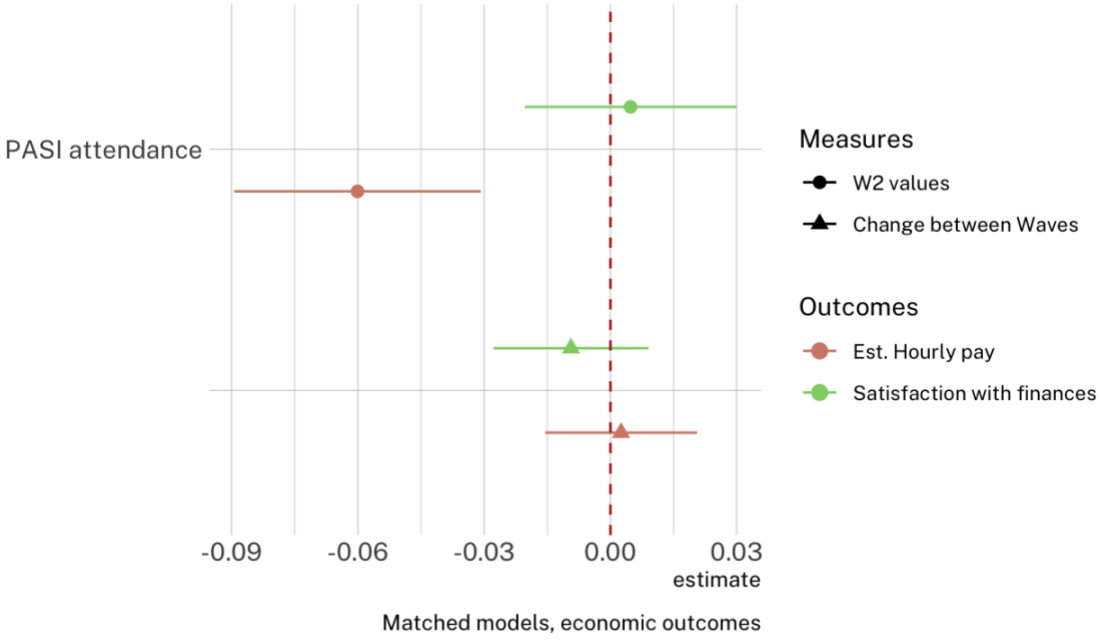
Our analysis of immigrants' resettlement experiences in Quebec and their intentions to remain in the province provides additional support for the role of public integration programs in fostering provincial attachment. PASI proves to have significant positive effects on both outcomes in Wave 2. The finding that program participation increases the probability of expressing intentions to remain in Quebec is particularly noteworthy for its policy implications. This suggests that *early participation* in integration programs may influence *long-term* settlement decisions. While we found limited evidence for direct effects on linguistic integration or feelings of belonging, these results indicate that the program works through broader channels of provincial engagement and attachment. The absence of significant changes between waves mirrors our earlier findings regarding political engagement, suggesting that PASI participants may begin with stronger provincial attachments that are maintained, rather than enhanced, through program participation.

Figure 4 - Average Treatment Effect of PASI programs on the Treated: Evaluation of the Immigration Experience in Quebec



Finally, in Figure 5, we turn to economic outcomes. In all analyses, we attempted to avoid matching on factors that might be *post*-immigration. However, due to the obvious close relationship between the two factors, when examining economic outcomes (and specifically estimated hourly compensation), we include full time employment as a matching covariate in this analysis.

Figure 5 - Average Treatment Effect of PASI programs on the Treated: Economic Outcomes



For Wave 2 values (the circles), PASI use leads to a significant negative effect on hourly pay ($\beta = -0.060$, $p < 0.001$), though we suspect this relationship reflects selection effects, wherein economically disadvantaged individuals are more likely to participate in PASI programming—a point we return to in our concluding analysis. We observe no significant effect of PASI on satisfaction with finances ($\beta = 0.005$, n.s.). When examining changes between waves (the dots, in the lower section of Figure 5), we see no significant effect of PASI on overtime change in hourly pay and satisfaction with one's financial situation, with both coefficients being very small in magnitude and statistically insignificant ($\beta = 0.003$ for estimated hourly pay and $\beta = -0.009$ for financial satisfaction).

In terms of economic integration, we suspect that the negative effect of PASI on hourly pay is driven by lower income immigrants being far more likely to engage with these programs. As shown in the appendix[13], in both waves participants in this programming reported lower wages than non-participants. Though we do our best to account for such factors by matching upon and including as covariates in the model, characteristics that may plausibly be expected to impact this outcome, such as level of formal education and full time employment status, we cannot dismiss this possibility. Supporting this conclusion is the fact that we do not find any notable effect in terms of change of income between waves, or on the measures of satisfaction with personal finances. So in terms of economic integration, PASI doesn't seem to have an effect in the time span of a year.

[13] Figure A4 in appendix.

Overall, our results provide mixed support for our theoretical expectations about the positive effect of PASI activities on recent immigrants' integration outcomes (H2). While we find clear positive impacts of PASI on social and political integration (confirming H2), we find no effects of PASI on linguistic and economic integration. However, this confirms our other expectation (H2a) that certain integration outcomes that are dependent on societal actors or economic structures may be harder to impact. For example, even if immigrants take part in integration activities and learn about how things work in employment in Quebec, their economic outcomes - such as employment status, type of employment and hourly pay - will not only depend on their will and motivation, but will also be dependent on the economic context (e.g. unemployment rate) and economic actors (e.g. businesses' decision to hire immigrants). Also, even if immigrants participate in cultural and linguistic activities to learn Québécois idioms and practice French, building the confidence to use a language takes time and practicing the language requires interlocutors willing to be open and patient. Thus, while recent immigrants may have the individual will and motivation to make progress on their economic and linguistic integration, they may face external obstacles to economic and linguistic participation, and taking part in an integration program might not be sufficient to overcome these obstacles.

Conclusion

In the context of increasing immigration flows, governments around the world have invested in public programs to assist immigrants in their resettlement process, in order to help them overcome some of the challenges linked to moving and adapting to a new country, with the objective to facilitate their integration. While the effectiveness and impact of these programs xxx, few studies have actually assessed whether these integration programs reach their target population (i.e. recent immigrants in need of support in their integration process), but also whether these programs actually deliver on their objectives (i.e. facilitating integration and participation in the host society). In addition, these studies are mostly short-term observational studies that cannot establish a causal link between participation in integration programs and later integration outcomes.

Our study aimed to fill in this gap in the literature, first, by examining whom, among recent immigrants, used the PASI integration program in Quebec, and second, what were the impacts of using such integration services and activities on immigrants integration in the medium-term. One of our main contributions is that we study the integration process and effect of public programs among *recent* immigrants - who are the target group of this public program -, but who are a hard to reach population for social surveys, and thus have never been the object of policy feedback studies. Our second important contribution is that we developed a strong methodological design to get closer to a *causal* assessment of the integration program's impact in the medium term, by capitalizing on an original panel survey and circumventing - at least partly - the issues of self-selection into program use. Thus, instead of comparing immigrants' integration outcomes to 'natives's baseline' as many other studies do, our study focuses on immigrants only, comparing integration outcomes and trajectories between the program users and non-users.

Our first results confirm our expectations about the groups of recent immigrants who use the PASI integration program. In fact, we find that the immigrants who are more likely to experience challenges in their early resettlement and integration process – older immigrants, women, individuals who are not citizens, immigrants who identify as racialized minorities, those

who do not have French as their primary language, individuals who did not arrive in Quebec through an economic program, those living outside of the metropolitan area of Montreal, and those who have arrived very recently in Quebec – were overall more likely to use the PASI integration program. This is good news, in terms of policy implementation, as those who are expected to experience more challenges in their resettlement and to need more support, are using the integration activities in greater numbers. Additionally, our results go against the ISSL literature (which expects a lower program uptake among the resourceless with limited abilities to access, understand, and navigate integration programs), which could indicate that the strategy to offer integration programs, not through traditional governmental channels, but through local community groups is successful in reaching the targeted clientele. That being said, some of the socio-demographic differences between groups of users and non-users are quite small, indicating that more could be done on the part of public institutions and community groups to advertise these services, facilitate access to the activities, and ultimately increase the program uptake among those in need of support and resources.

The second part of our analyses used full matching to assess more precisely the causal impact of PASI use on a variety of integration outcomes. We find that PASI use is linked to higher social and political outcomes. In fact, immigrants who reported using the PASI integration activities in Wave 1 later report - in Wave 2 - higher levels of political interest and knowledge, better life experiences in Quebec, more intentions to stay in the province, and much higher rates of volunteering. However, in Wave 2, PASI users were *not* more likely to use French in public spaces or to say they feel competent in French, nor were they more likely to say they feel satisfied with their financial situation, and they actually reported having lower hourly pay (than non-users). Several factors may explain these results. First, while matching techniques circumvent the issue of self-selection into program use and produce 'more similar and comparable' groups of users and non-users, it may be the case that we cannot fully solve the self-selection issue and that our groups of users and non-users differ in some other ways (i.e. on other characteristics we haven't measured). For example, it is likely the case that PASI users are initially more likely (than non-users) to experience employment challenges and have lower earnings potential, and that despite their participation in PASI programs, they are not able to overcome these challenges (and this is why we find that they have lower earnings in Wave 2). Related to that point, a second explanation is that the group activities of the PASI program (some that might combine 4 sessions of 3 hours, and some that might only last 2 hours), might not be enough to overcome more structural or contextual integration obstacles, as those experienced in employment or language acquisition. Furthermore, the majority of the activities used in our study are cultural or civic activities, and not economic activities or linguistic activities, and so it shouldn't be a surprise that we find more effects on social outcomes, than on linguistic or economic integration outcomes.

While our study improves on past research on integration programs, it nonetheless presents certain limitations[14]. First, we examine one integration program in one specific national context, which can limit the generalizability of our findings. However, as Quebec tends to select more educated and resourceful immigrants to settle in the province, we believe that Quebec may be a hard test for the study of integration programs' impact, and that we should find stronger program

[14] As with any analysis using panel data, there was the possibility of differential attrition along characteristics that may influence the results. Although those successfully recontacted did not notably differ from dropouts along most characteristics, respondents with a higher level of formal education were more likely to be successfully recontacted. Figure A5 in the appendix shows this. Though we think it is unlikely this substantially influenced our results, the possibility cannot totally be discounted.

effects in other national contexts. Secondly, even if we estimated the program's medium-term effects over one year, it may be argued that cultural adaptation and language acquisition require more time, and that the effects of programs should be assessed in the longer run.

Based on the findings of this study, we see that integration programs can indeed facilitate recent immigrant's integration in a number of ways, even if not in all domains of life in the medium term. Hence, with some evidence of integration programs' effectiveness, it seems relevant for governments to continue to fund and further develop and ameliorate such activities, with the idea that they can help support immigrants' inclusion in their host society and foster social cohesion in diverse societies.

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APPENDIX

Table A1. Classification of PASI integration activities by Activity Category

Activity Name	Category (Proposed)	N W1	N W2
French discussion workshop	Linguistic Activities	259	90
Women-only discussion group	Community/Cultural Activities	97	30
Men-only discussion group	Community/Cultural Activities	32	15
Intercultural exchange	Community/Cultural Activities	139	55
Cultural activities or outings	Community/Cultural Activities	258	123
Information or discussion session on Quebec values and culture	Civic/Administrative Activities	217	62
Workshop on Quebec history or your region's history	Civic/Administrative Activities	147	54
Workshop on winter in Quebec	Civic/Administrative Activities	69	39
Espace Parents or a parenting workshop	Community/Cultural Activities	108	53
Collective kitchen	Community/Cultural Activities	50	43
Intercultural meal	Community/Cultural Activities	114	87
Coffee-meeting or coffee-conference	Community/Cultural Activities	134	61
Volunteer work or visit to a community organization	Community/Cultural Activities	179	114
Sports activities or outings	Community/Cultural Activities	131	87
Meeting with elected officials / police officers / public institutions	Civic/Administrative Activities	83	29
Workshop on rights (citizen's / worker's / women's)	Civic/Administrative Activities	120	52
Information workshop on the political system or voting	Civic/Administrative Activities	56	26
Visit to the National Assembly or a Town Hall	Civic/Administrative Activities	39	36
Workshop on housing (rights and responsibility)	Civic/Administrative Activities	120	54
Information workshop on the legal system or the health system	Civic/Administrative Activities	104	39
Information workshop on the school system or social services	Civic/Administrative Activities	167	62
Workshop on finances (budgeting / taxes / banking)	Economic Activities	157	61
Workshop on employment / the job market or professional networking activity	Economic Activities	268	108
Workshop on the driver’s license or driving in Quebec	Civic/Administrative Activities	64	32

Table A2. Logistic Regressions to Model Activity Participation Probability

	PGA Participation in W1	LA Participation in W1	CC Activity Participation in W1	EA Participation in W1	ASA Participation in W1
(Intercept)	-2.84***	-3.39***	-3.17***	-4.17***	-3.87***
	(0.33)	(0.56)	(0.34)	(0.43)	(0.41)
Age	0.02***	0.01+	0.02**	0.03***	0.02**
	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)
Woman	0.25*	0.43**	0.42***	0.23+	0.25+
	(0.10)	(0.16)	(0.11)	(0.13)	(0.13)
University Diploma	0.09	-0.13	0.22+	-0.03	0.03
	(0.12)	(0.19)	(0.13)	(0.15)	(0.15)
Non-Francophone	0.43***		0.32**	0.49**	0.75***
	(0.11)		(0.12)	(0.15)	(0.15)
Children	0.14	-0.11	0.14	0.05	-0.06
	(0.11)	(0.16)	(0.11)	(0.13)	(0.13)
Non-Montreal Region	0.28**	-0.33*	0.34**	0.29*	0.55***
	(0.11)	(0.17)	(0.11)	(0.13)	(0.13)
Racial Minority	0.53***	0.31	0.61***	0.35+	0.05
	(0.15)	(0.26)	(0.16)	(0.20)	(0.18)
Not Canadian Citizen	0.20	0.06	0.20	0.63**	0.68**
	(0.15)	(0.25)	(0.15)	(0.21)	(0.21)
Non-economic Program	0.47***	0.40*	0.34**	0.17	0.44***
	(0.11)	(0.16)	(0.11)	(0.13)	(0.13)
0-1 year in QC	1.18***	1.25**	0.83***	0.76**	0.35
	(0.24)	(0.41)	(0.23)	(0.28)	(0.27)
2-3 years in QC	0.46*	1.22***	0.21	0.25	0.22
	(0.18)	(0.35)	(0.19)	(0.24)	(0.22)
4-5 years in QC	0.12	0.73*	-0.05	-0.10	-0.37+
	(0.17)	(0.34)	(0.18)	(0.23)	(0.21)
6-7 years in QC	-0.14	0.33	-0.26	0.07	-0.08
	(0.19)	(0.38)	(0.20)	(0.25)	(0.23)
Num.Obs.	1732	1151	1732	1732	1732
AIC	2230.31	1051.88	2119.06	1577.12	1634.81
BIC	2306.71	1117.51	2195.45	1653.52	1711.21
Adj. R2	0.09	0.04	0.07	0.04	0.06
RMSE	0.47	0.37	0.46	0.38	0.38
Log.Lik.	-1101.15	-512.94	-1045.53	-774.56	-803.40

p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Figure A1: Covariate balance for general participation, all respondents

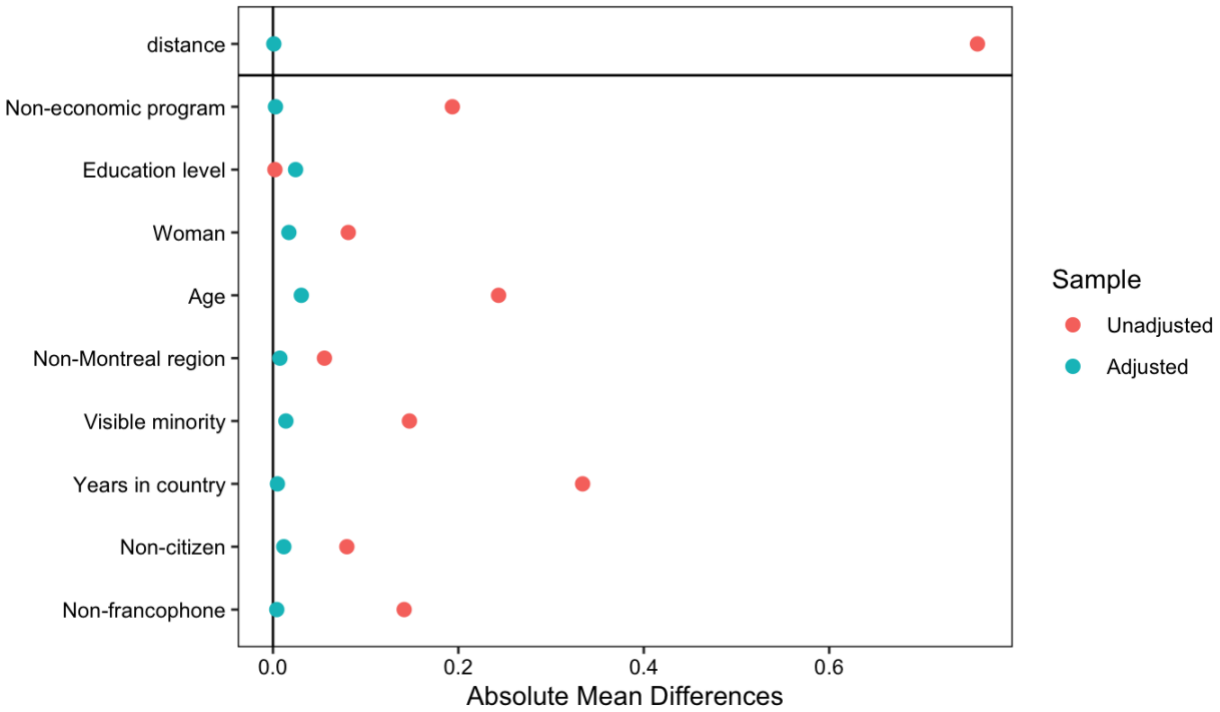


Figure A2: Covariate balance for general participation, exlcuding native francophones

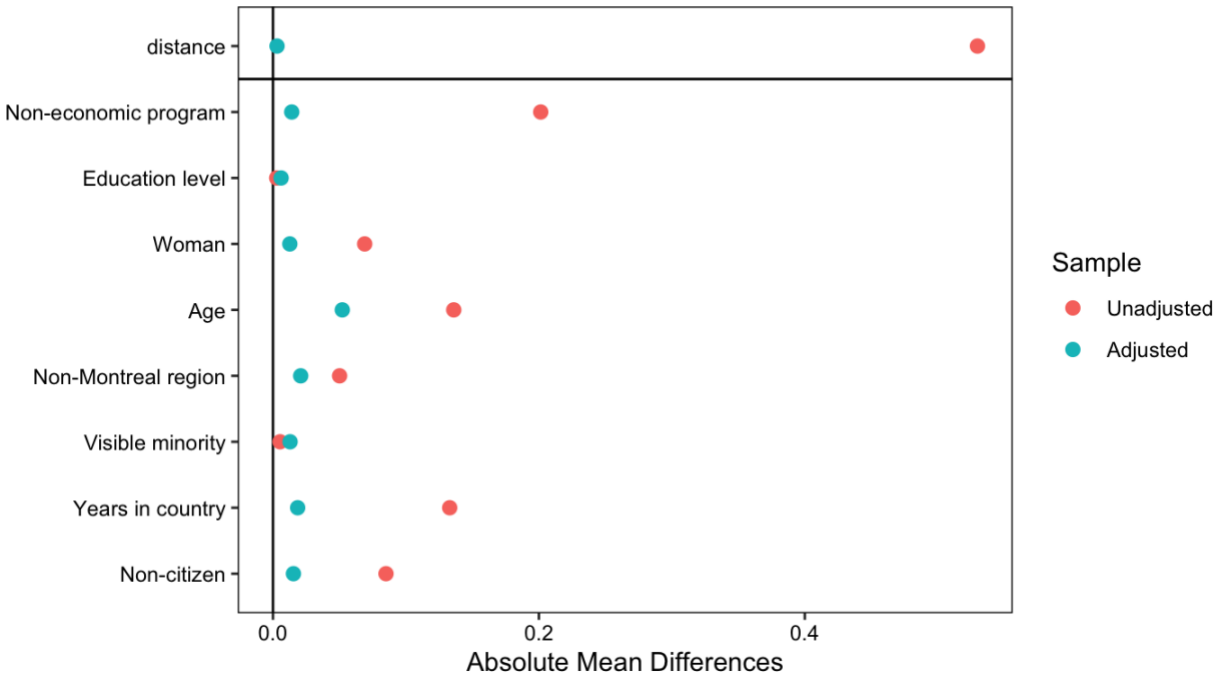


Figure A3: Covariate balance for general participation, including match on employment

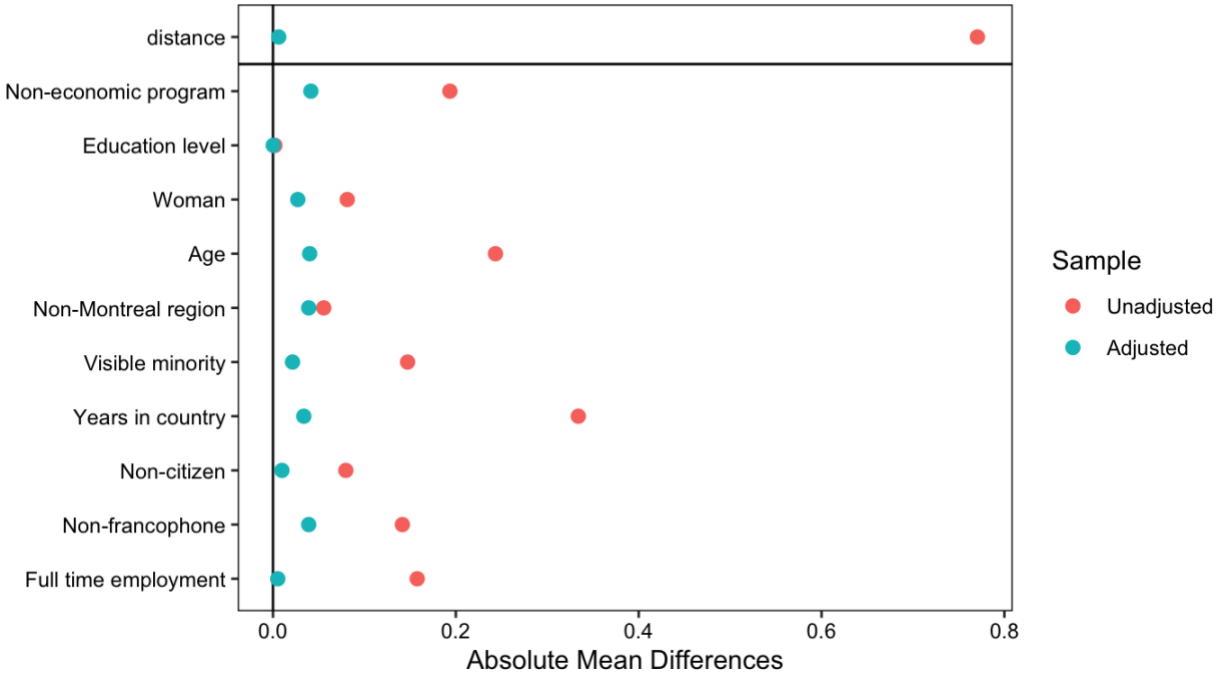


Table A3: Matched models: political and social outcomes

	Wave 2 values				Change between waves			
	Political Engagement	Political Knowledge	Feeling of Belonging	Volunteerism	Political Engagement	Political Knowledge	Feeling of Belonging	Volunteerism
(Intercept)	0.363***	0.514***	0.539***	0.117	0.461***	0.539***	0.421***	0.550***
	(0.060)	(0.069)	(0.045)	(0.079)	(0.033)	(0.035)	(0.022)	(0.037)
PASI attendance	0.044*	0.058**	0.021	0.240***	-0.019*	0.011	-0.007	0.028**
	(0.017)	(0.020)	(0.013)	(0.023)	(0.009)	(0.010)	(0.006)	(0.011)
Num.Obs.	936	959	957	939	893	951	948	921
R2	0.083	0.065	0.058	0.137	0.026	0.017	0.020	0.024
R2 Adj.	0.073	0.055	0.049	0.128	0.015	0.007	0.010	0.013
AIC	455.1	741.8	-60.1	977.9	-702.1	-562.6	-1459.9	-434.1
BIC	513.2	800.2	-1.8	1036.0	-644.5	-504.3	-1401.6	-376.2
Log.Lik.	-215.543	-358.893	42.059	-476.931	363.035	293.291	741.931	229.067
RMSE	0.27	0.31	0.20	0.35	0.14	0.15	0.10	0.16

· $p < 0.1$, * $p < 0.05$, ** $p < 0.01$, *** $p < 0.001$

Covariates for economic program participation, education level, francophone status, gender, age, region of residence, visible minority status, presence of children, citizenship status, and years in country were included in the model but are not shown, as this is a post-matching model.

Table A4: Matched models, linguistic outcomes

	Wave 2 values		Change between waves	
	Public French Use	French Competency	Public French Use	French Competency
(Intercept)	0.480***	0.694***	0.571***	0.514***
	(0.093)	(0.057)	(0.048)	(0.028)
PASI attendance	-0.053+	0.002	-0.005	-0.005
	(0.028)	(0.017)	(0.015)	(0.008)
Num.Obs.	643	607	643	606
R2	0.064	0.044	0.015	0.040
R2 Adj.	0.051	0.030	0.001	0.026
AIC	645.2	-42.1	-196.0	-913.5
BIC	694.3	6.4	-146.8	-865.0
Log.Lik.	-311.579	32.045	108.977	467.755
RMSE	0.35	0.21	0.17	0.10

· $p < 0.1$, * $p < 0.05$, ** $p < 0.01$, *** $p < 0.001$

Excludes native French speakers. Covariates for economic program participation, education level, gender, age, region of residence, visible minority status, presence of children, citizenship status, and years in country were included in the model but are not shown, as this is a post-matching model.

Table A5: Satisfaction outcomes, matched

	Wave 2 values				Change between waves |			
	Life experiences in QC W2	Staying in QC W2	Feeling of Belonging W2	Volunteerism W2	Life experiences in QC Change	Staying in QC Change	Feeling of Belonging Change	Volunteerism Change
(Intercept)	0.587***	0.432***	0.539***	0.117	0.544***	0.509***	0.421***	0.550***
	(0.038)	(0.086)	(0.045)	(0.079)	(0.028)	(0.044)	(0.022)	(0.037)
PASI attendance	0.025*	0.075**	0.021	0.240***	-0.002	-0.009	-0.007	0.028**
	(0.011)	(0.025)	(0.013)	(0.023)	(0.008)	(0.013)	(0.006)	(0.011)
Num.Obs.	959	965	957	939	958	965	948	921
R2	0.040	0.054	0.058	0.137	0.019	0.009	0.020	0.024
R2 Adj.	0.030	0.044	0.049	0.128	0.009	-0.001	0.010	0.013
AIC	-380.3	1194.1	-60.1	977.9	-992.2	-100.8	-1459.9	-434.1
BIC	-321.9	1252.5	-1.8	1036.0	-933.8	-42.4	-1401.6	-376.2
Log.Lik.	202.148	-585.041	42.059	-476.931	508.096	62.419	741.931	229.067
RMSE	0.18	0.40	0.20	0.35	0.12	0.21	0.10	0.16

· $p < 0.1$, * $p < 0.05$, ** $p < 0.01$, *** $p < 0.001$

Table A6:Satisfaction outcomes, unmatched

	Wave 2 values		Change between waves	
	Life experiences in QC W2	Staying in QC W2	Life experiences in QC Change	Staying in QC Change
(Intercept)	0.668***	0.426***	0.566***	0.473***
	(0.037)	(0.085)	(0.026)	(0.044)
PASI attendance	0.006	0.093***	-0.010	-0.010
	(0.012)	(0.028)	(0.009)	(0.014)
Non-economic program	0.024*	0.036	0.013	0.011
	(0.012)	(0.028)	(0.009)	(0.014)
Education level	-0.018	-0.032	0.009	0.003
	(0.014)	(0.032)	(0.010)	(0.017)
Woman	0.004	-0.011	0.013	0.017
	(0.011)	(0.026)	(0.008)	(0.014)
Age	0.001	0.005**	0.000	0.000
	(0.001)	(0.002)	(0.000)	(0.001)
Non-Montreal region	0.039***	0.106***	0.005	0.013
	(0.011)	(0.026)	(0.008)	(0.014)

Visible minority	-0.019	0.061+	0.002	0.030+
	(0.015)	(0.034)	(0.010)	(0.017)
Years in country	0.001	-0.001	-0.003**	-0.003
	(0.002)	(0.004)	(0.001)	(0.002)
Non-citizen	0.033*	0.049	0.017	-0.003
	(0.016)	(0.037)	(0.012)	(0.019)
Non-francophone	-0.002	0.002	-0.006	-0.009
	(0.013)	(0.029)	(0.009)	(0.015)
Num.Obs.	959	965	958	965
R2	0.031	0.062	0.021	0.009
R2 Adj.	0.020	0.053	0.010	-0.001
AIC	-614.4	1001.8	-1256.8	-278.9
BIC	-556.0	1060.3	-1198.5	-220.4
Log.Lik.	319.203	-488.896	640.424	151.430
RMSE	0.17	0.40	0.12	0.21

· $p < 0.1$, * $p < 0.05$, ** $p < 0.01$, *** $p < 0.001$

Table A7: Matched models, economic outcomes

	Wave 2 values		Change between waves	
	Est. Hourly pay	Satisfaction with finances	Est. Hourly pay	Satisfaction with finances
(Intercept)	0.777***	0.464***	0.433***	0.452***
	(0.054)	(0.046)	(0.034)	(0.034)
PASI attendance	-0.060***	0.005	0.003	-0.009
	(0.015)	(0.013)	(0.009)	(0.009)
Num.Obs.	763	962	647	959
R2	0.284	0.064	0.023	0.068
R2 Adj.	0.274	0.053	0.006	0.057
AIC	-3.4	-80.9	-738.4	-678.7
BIC	56.9	-17.6	-680.3	-615.5
Log.Lik.	14.708	53.454	382.196	352.360
RMSE	0.20	0.20	0.12	0.14

· $p < 0.1$, * $p < 0.05$, ** $p < 0.01$, *** $p < 0.001$

Covariates for full time employment, economic program participation, education level, francophone status, gender, age, region of residence, visible minority status, presence of children, citizenship status, and years in country were included in the model but are not shown, as this is a post-matching model.

Table A8: Unmatched models, Political and Social outcomes

	Wave 2 values				Change between waves			
	Political Engagement	Political Knowledge	Feeling of Belonging	Volunteerism	Political Engagement	Political Knowledge	Feeling of Belonging	Volunteerism
(Intercept)	0.423***	0.542***	0.583***	0.080	0.450***	0.520***	0.421***	0.529***
	(0.058)	(0.065)	(0.043)	(0.075)	(0.030)	(0.032)	(0.021)	(0.035)
PASI attendance	0.034+	0.048*	0.020	0.227***	-0.024*	0.002	-0.008	0.017
	(0.019)	(0.021)	(0.014)	(0.025)	(0.010)	(0.010)	(0.007)	(0.011)
Non-economic program	0.002	0.016	0.018	0.011	-0.014	0.010	-0.002	-0.017
	(0.019)	(0.021)	(0.014)	(0.025)	(0.010)	(0.010)	(0.007)	(0.011)
Education level	0.026	0.024	-0.019	0.061*	0.003	-0.001	0.011	-0.005
	(0.023)	(0.025)	(0.016)	(0.029)	(0.012)	(0.012)	(0.008)	(0.013)
Woman	-0.096***	-0.069***	0.004	0.005	-0.002	-0.002	0.014*	-0.002
	(0.018)	(0.020)	(0.013)	(0.023)	(0.009)	(0.010)	(0.006)	(0.011)
Age	0.002*	0.000	0.004***	-0.002	0.000	0.000	0.001*	-0.001
	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.000)	(0.001)
Non-Montreal region	0.047*	0.065**	0.045***	0.080***	-0.002	-0.006	-0.003	0.027*
	(0.018)	(0.020)	(0.013)	(0.024)	(0.009)	(0.010)	(0.006)	(0.011)

Visible minority	-0.026	-0.021	-0.006	0.002	0.033**	0.000	-0.013	0.012
	(0.023)	(0.026)	(0.017)	(0.030)	(0.012)	(0.013)	(0.008)	(0.014)
Years in country	0.007*	0.013***	0.000	0.013***	-0.001	-0.001	-0.001	-0.002
	(0.003)	(0.003)	(0.002)	(0.004)	(0.001)	(0.002)	(0.001)	(0.002)
Non-citizen	-0.038	0.005	0.029	0.034	0.000	0.019	0.010	0.000
	(0.025)	(0.029)	(0.019)	(0.033)	(0.013)	(0.014)	(0.009)	(0.015)
Non-francophone	0.005	-0.040+	-0.029*	0.033	-0.011	-0.029**	0.006	0.019
	(0.020)	(0.022)	(0.014)	(0.026)	(0.010)	(0.011)	(0.007)	(0.012)
Num.Obs.	936	959	957	939	893	951	948	921
R2	0.058	0.054	0.055	0.119	0.021	0.012	0.018	0.019
R2 Adj.	0.048	0.044	0.045	0.110	0.010	0.002	0.008	0.008
AIC	239.6	490.2	-336.7	732.9	-998.2	-866.7	-1708.2	-731.2
BIC	297.7	548.6	-278.4	791.1	-940.7	-808.4	-1649.9	-673.3
Log.Lik.	-107.807	-233.100	180.366	-354.466	511.100	445.349	866.078	377.582
RMSE	0.27	0.31	0.20	0.35	0.14	0.15	0.10	0.16

· $p < 0.1$, * $p < 0.05$, ** $p < 0.01$, *** $p < 0.001$

Table A9: Linguistic outcomes, unmatched

	Wave 2 values		Change between waves	
	Public French Use	French Competency	Public French Use	French Competency
(Intercept)	0.693***	0.757***	0.509***	0.519***
	(0.072)	(0.055)	(0.036)	(0.026)
PASI attendance	-0.094***	0.010	-0.004	0.004
	(0.023)	(0.017)	(0.012)	(0.008)
Non-economic program	-0.084***	-0.070***	0.009	0.020*
	(0.023)	(0.017)	(0.012)	(0.008)
Education level	0.043	-0.001	0.013	-0.018+
	(0.028)	(0.021)	(0.014)	(0.010)
Woman	0.011	-0.020	0.004	-0.003
	(0.022)	(0.017)	(0.011)	(0.008)
Age	0.002	0.000	-0.001	0.001
	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.000)
Non-Montreal region	0.097***	0.058***	0.019+	-0.006
	(0.023)	(0.017)	(0.011)	(0.008)
Visible minority	-0.071*	-0.005	-0.013	-0.033**
	(0.028)	(0.023)	(0.014)	(0.011)
Years in country	-0.012***	0.001	0.000	0.000
	(0.003)	(0.002)	(0.002)	(0.001)
Non-citizen	-0.036	-0.029	0.015	0.011
	(0.032)	(0.023)	(0.016)	(0.011)

Num.Obs.	964	658	964	606
R2	0.067	0.045	0.009	0.039
R2 Adj.	0.059	0.032	0.000	0.024
AIC	696.0	-160.5	-646.1	-1077.6
BIC	749.6	-111.2	-592.6	-1029.1
Log.Lik.	-337.008	91.272	334.067	549.799
RMSE	0.34	0.21	0.17	0.10

· $p < 0.1$, * $p < 0.05$, ** $p < 0.01$, *** $p < 0.001$

Table A10. Variables Used in the First Step of the Analysis (Examining Use of PASI program)

Variable	Question Wording	Answer Choices	Coding
Age	"In what **year** were you born?"	Drop-down list from which respondents can select their year of birth or "I don't know."	The year of birth is subtracted from the current year (2023) to determine the respondent's age. Respondents who selected "I don't know" are coded as missing.
Has Children	"How many children under 18 live with you?"	Drop-down list from which respondents can select "I prefer not to answer", or any option ranging from "0" to "8 or more."	If the respondent either chose "0" or had previously mentioned living alone, the variable's value was set to 0. For any other selection except for "I prefer not to answer" (which leads to exclusion from analyses), the value was assigned as 1.
Income	"Which of these options best describes **your annual income *before taxes* for the year 2022**? Make sure to include all of your income sources." AND "Which of these options best describes **your household's annual income *before taxes* for the year 2022**? Make sure to include all of your income sources."	(1) No income, (2) Between $1 and $29,999, (3) Between $30,000 and $59,999, (4) Between $60,000 and $89,999, (5) Between $90,000 and $109,999, (6) Between $110,000 and $149,999, (7) Between $150,000 and $199,999, (8) More than $200,000, (9) I don't know.	If the respondent stated they live alone, the question about household income was not asked, and the individual income value was used instead. "I don't know" responses were recorded as NA. The answers from both questions were then combined and assigned numeric values according to the income categories. These categories were mapped to values between 0 and 1, forming a linear representation of income for the purpose of analysis.
University Degree	"What is your highest **completed educational level**?"	(1) No education, (2) Less than a high school diploma, (3) High school diploma, (4) Cegep, college or trade school diploma, (5) Undergraduate level degree (Bachelor's degree or diploma), (6) Graduate level degree, (7) Ph.D. or postgraduate professional degree (medicine, optometry, law…), (8) I don't know.	Respondents who indicated they have an "Undergraduate level degree (Bachelor's degree or diploma)", "Graduate level degree", or "Ph.D. or postgraduate professional degree (medicine, optometry, law…)" are recoded as 1. All other responses, including "No education", "Less than a high school diploma", "High school diploma", "Cegep, college or trade school diploma", and "I don't know", are recoded as 0, indicating that the respondent does not have a university degree.
Racial Minority	"Many Canadian surveys use the following categories to collect social statistics. According to these categories, which ethnic or cultural groups do you belong to?"	(1) White, (2) Indigenous (e.g. First Nations, Métis, Inuit, etc.), (3) Chinese, (4) South Asian (e.g. Indian, Pakistani, Sri Lankan, etc.), (5) Black, (6) Filipino/Filipina, (7) Latino American, (8) Arab, (9) Southeast Asian (e.g. Cambodian, Indonesian, Laotian, Vietnamese,	If the respondent does not identify as "White", the value is set to 1. Otherwise, if the respondent identifies as "White", the value is set to 0.

Variable	Question Wording	Answer Choices	Coding
		etc.), (10) West Asian (e.g. Afghan, Iranian, etc.), (11) Japanese, (12) Korean, (13) I prefer not to answer, (14) Other (Please specify)	
French as First Language	"What is the **first language** you learned and still speak?"	(1) French, (2) English, (3) Arabic, (4) Kabyle, (5) Chinese, Cantonese, Mandarin, (6) Filipino/Tagalog, (7) German, (8) Indian, Hindi, Gujarati, (9) Italian, (10) Korean, (11) Pakistani, Punjabi, Urdu, (12) Persian, Farsi, (13) Russian, (14) Spanish, Catalan, (15) Portuguese, (16) Tamil, (17) Vietnamese, (18) Other, (19) I don't know.	Respondents who chose "French" as their language were assigned a code of "1", while all other choices were assigned a code of "0".
Woman	"What is your gender?"	(1) Man, (2) Woman, (3) I identify differently, (4) I'd rather not say.	Respondents who indicated they identify as "Man" are recoded as "0" and "Woman" are recoded as "1". Responses of "I identify differently" and "I'd rather not say" are recoded as missing.
Working Full-Time	"What is your current occupation? Check all the boxes that apply"	(1) Working for pay full-time, (2) Working for pay part-time, (3) Self-employed (with or without employees), (4) Unemployed/looking for work, (5) Full-time student, (6) Part-time student, (7) Stay-at-home dad / mom / parent, (8) Unemployed because of a disability, (9) Retired, (10) Other (please specify).	If a respondent chose the option "Working for pay full-time," they are coded as "1." Otherwise, they are assigned the value "0."
Montréal Region	"In which **region** do you live?"	Drop-down menu containing all of Quebec's administrative regions	If a respondent selected "Montréal," they are coded as one. Otherwise, they are assigned the value "0."
Years Since Arrival in Quebec	"What year did you move to Quebec? (The year in which you settled permanently and continuously in Quebec)"	Drop-down list from which respondents can select their year of arrival or "I don't know."	The year of arrival is subtracted from the current year (2023). Respondents who selected "I don't know" are coded as missing.
Immigration Program	"Under which immigration program did you **obtain** your **permanent residence** in Canada?"	(1) The refugee program, (2) The family reunification program (partners, parents, grandparents, children), (3) An economic program (qualified workers program, Quebec experience program, business program, etc.), (4) I do not have permanent residency, (5) Other, please specify, (6) I don't know.	The categories are retained in their original form. Respondents who chose the "I don't know" option are not included in the dataset. Additionally, three binary variables are created corresponding to each of the three branches of programs: the Family Reunification Program, an Economic Program, and the Refugee Program. A response aligning with the respective program is coded as 1, while all other responses are coded as 0.
Canadian Citizen	"Are you a…"	(1) Canadian citizen, (2) Permanent resident, (3) Other status, (4) I don't know.	The original categories for citizenship status were preserved. Respondents who selected "I don't know" as their citizenship status were excluded from the analysis. Additionally, a new binary variable was created, where respondents who chose "Canadian citizen" were coded as 1, while those who selected any other valid option were coded as 0.

Table A11 Step 2 Outcomes
NB: In final models all outcomes were rescaled 0-1 for consistency

Integration Outcome	Variable Operationalization	Question Wording	Answer Choices	Coding

Political engagement	Expressed interest in Quebec politics	What level of interest do you have in politics? (Quebec politics)	Scale 0-10 from "No interest" to "A lot of interest", plus "I don't know"	0-10 scale, "I don't know" coded as missing
Political knowledge	Knowledge of political figures	Association task with four political figures and their roles (e.g., Justin Trudeau, Geneviève Guilbault, Mélanie Joly, Gabriel Nadeau-Dubois)	Multiple choice matching of figures to roles	Score based on correct identification of current Quebec and Canadian political figures, scaled 0 to 1
Belonging in Quebec	Feeling of belonging	On a scale of 0 to 10, what is your level of attachment...to Quebec	Scale 0-10 from "Not attached at all" to "Very attached", plus "I don't know"	0-10 scale, "I don't know" coded as missing
Public French use	French usage	Please indicate the approximate proportion of time you speak French, English, or other languages...in the street or in stores	Percentage allocation across languages totaling 100%	Proportion of French usage, scaled 0 to 1
French competency	French ability	On a scale of 0 to 10, tell us what your level of competency is in...French	Scale 0-10 from "I have not mastered the language at all" to "I have perfect mastery", plus "I don't know"	0-10 scale, "I don't know" coded as missing

Volunteerism	Volunteer participation	In the past 12 months, have you done volunteer work with a group or an organization?	Yes once, Yes a few times, Yes often, No never, I don't know	Ordinal scale coded 0-3 (Never=0, Often=3), "I don't know" as missing
Subjective experience	Evaluation of Quebec experience	In general, on a scale of 0 to 10, how would you rate your life experience during the past year in Quebec?	Scale 0-10 from "Very negative" to "Very positive", plus "I don't know"	0-10 scale, "I don't know" coded as missing
Intent to stay	Likelihood of staying	Do you think you'll stay in Quebec for the next 10 years?	Multiple choices including staying in current city, moving within Quebec, or leaving Quebec	Binary coding (1=staying in Quebec, 0=planning to leave)
Income	Estimated hourly pay	What is your current hourly rate for your job right now?	Drop-down ranges from "Less than $10.00/hour" to higher ranges	Mid-point of selected range, scaled 0 to 1
Financial satisfaction	Satisfaction with finances	Please indicate your current satisfaction level with...Your current financial situation	Scale 0-10 from "Completely unsatisfied" to "Completely satisfied", plus "I don't know"	0-10 scale, "I don't know" coded as missing

Figure A4: Political engagement and estimated hourly wage between waves by participant status

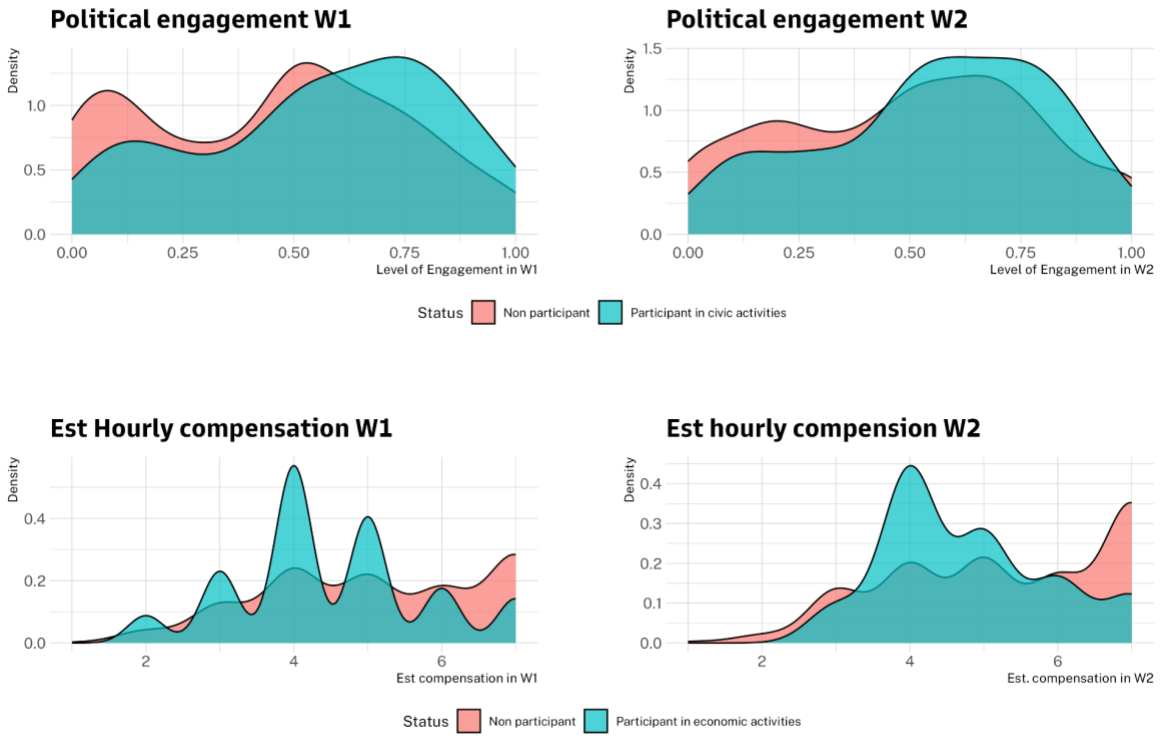
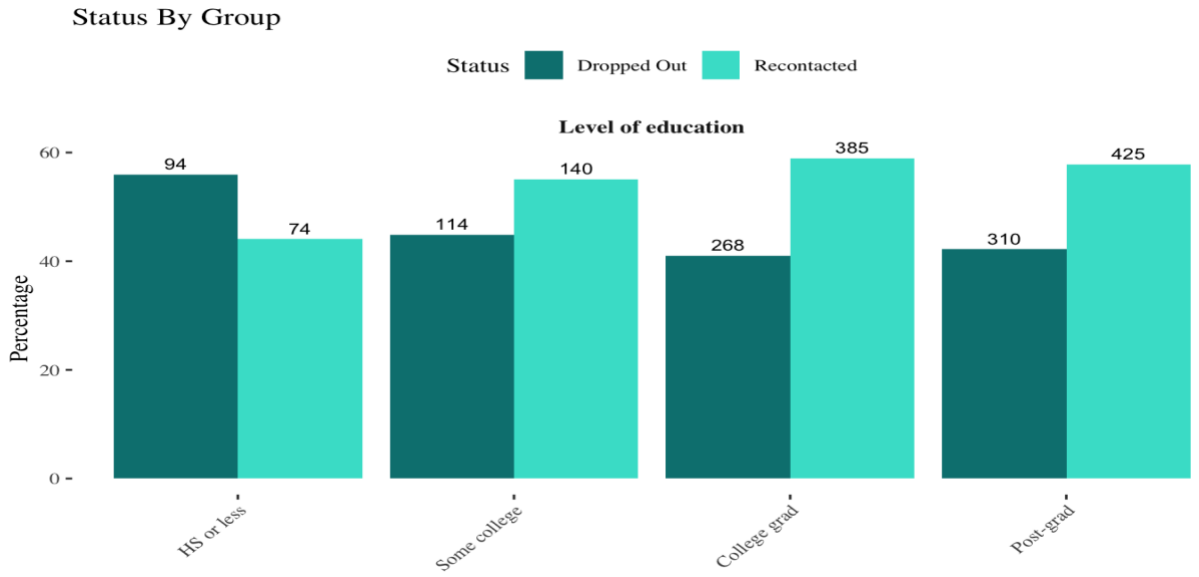


Figure A5: Attrition by level of formal education



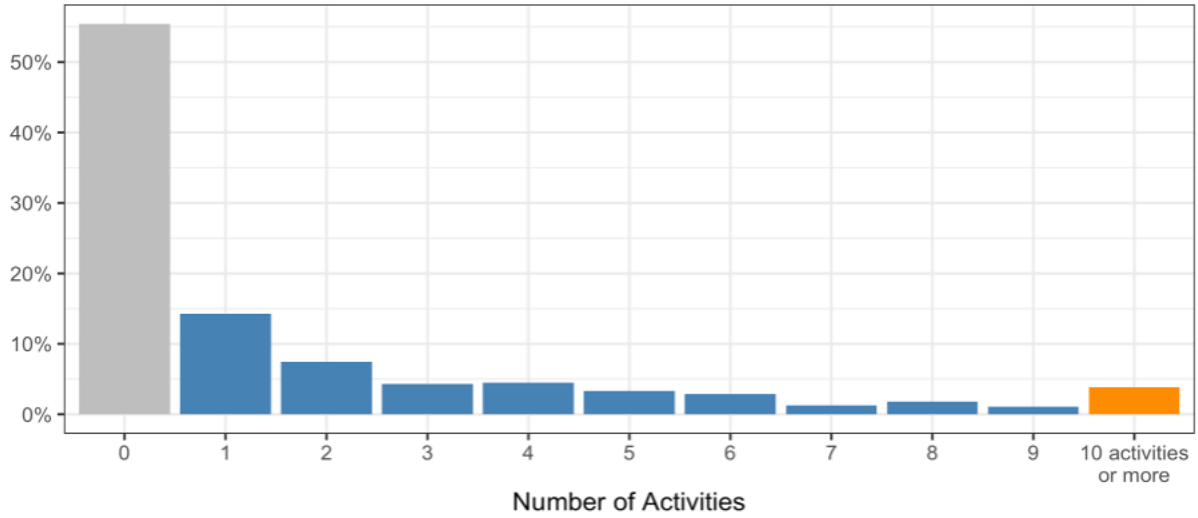

50%
40%
30%
20%
10%
0%
0
1
2
3
4
5
6
7
8
9
10 activities or more
Number of Activities

Figure A6